

ANGLAIS • 1RE TECH

ANGLAIS – CLASSE DE PREMIÈRE TECHNIQUE

LEÇON N02

ECONOMIC LIFE AND OCCUPATIONS

DURÉE CONSEILLÉE : 13 SÉANCES (FICHE DE PROGRESSION HARMONISÉE)

DANS CETTE LEÇON

Cette leçon plonge l'apprenant dans la vie économique quotidienne du Cameroun : achats et ventes au marché, gestion des finances personnelles et découverte des métiers. À travers des activités de speaking, listening, reading, grammar et writing, l'élève maîtrise le vocabulaire commercial, les requêtes polies, les articles partitifs et les quantifieurs pour communiquer efficacement dans des situations économiques réelles.

- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais échanger des informations sur l'achat et la vente d'articles et de denrées dans un magasin ou un marché proche
- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais formuler des requêtes et suggestions polies avec 'let me + infinitif', 'please', 'could you', 'can you'
- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais utiliser correctement les articles partitifs (a bunch of, a cup of, a loaf of...) pour quantifier les denrées
- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais comprendre des textes oraux sur la gestion des finances personnelles
- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais employer les adjectifs nominalisés et les structures 'So do I' / 'Neither did he' pour exprimer l'accord et le désaccord
- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais utiliser les déterminants et quantifieurs (some, any, much, all, most, few, a few, little, a little, each, every, many, both, no, none)



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OBJECTIFS DE LA LEÇON

- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais échanger des informations sur l'achat et la vente d'articles et de denrées dans un magasin ou un marché proche
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- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais lire et comprendre des textes sur le développement et le partage d'intérêt pour un métier ou une profession
- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais rédiger une composition sur le développement et le partage d'intérêt pour un métier, en justifiant ma démarche
- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais appliquer ces notions à des situations concrètes de la vie économique camerounaise

PRÉREQUIS

- Vocabulaire de base de la vie quotidienne acquis en classe de Seconde (food, money, shops)
- Structures simples du présent et du passé (simple present, simple past)
- Notions élémentaires sur les noms dénombrables et indénombrables
- Expressions de politesse de base (please, thank you, excuse me)
- Capacité à tenir un dialogue simple appris en début d'année

1 BUYING AND SELLING AT THE MARKET (SPEAKING & VOCABULARY)

Situation d'accroche. It is Saturday morning, 7 a.m., at Mokolo Market in Yaoundé. Amina, a student in Première technique, is walking behind her mother between the noisy stalls. Her mother gives her a shopping list : a bunch of plantains, a cup of groundnuts, and a bottle of palm oil. But today, there is a challenge : the seller is a woman from Bamenda who speaks only English. Amina must ask the prices, bargain, pay and thank her — all in English! In the evening, her father, a carpenter, will ask her to help him manage the small family budget and to write a short text about his trade.

Problématique : How can Amina use English to buy, sell, manage her money and talk about her future profession? This lesson gives her — and you — all the necessary linguistic tools. We start with the first skill : **buying and selling at the market**.

1.1 Discovering the Market : Key Vocabulary

Before you can buy anything, you must know the names of the goods. At a Cameroonian market, you find **foodstuff** (denrées alimentaires) and **articles** (articles, marchandises). Study the following lists carefully.

DÉFINITION Key words

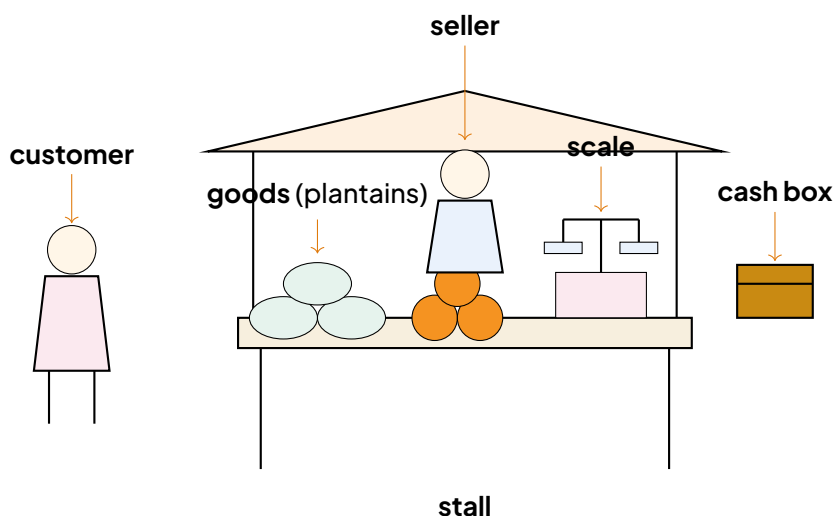
A **market** is a place where people buy and sell goods. A **stall** (étal) is the small table or stand where a seller displays goods. The **seller** or **vendor** (vendeur) sells ; the **customer** (client) buys. The **goods** (marchandises) are the things sold. A **scale** (balance) is used to weigh goods, and the **cash box** (caisse) is where the seller keeps the money.

Foodstuff at the Cameroonian market (les denrées) :

English	Français	English	Français
plantains	plantains	tomatoes	tomates
cassava	manioc	palm oil	huile de palme
groundnuts	arachides	dried fish	poisson fumé/séché
maize	maïs	cocoyams	taro/macabo
beans	haricots	pepper	piment
rice	riz	onions	oignons

Other articles (autres articles) : second-hand clothes (vêtements d'occasion), shoes (chaussures), soap (savon), cooking pots (marmites), fabric / wax (pagne), school supplies (fournitures scolaires).

People and places : customer (client), seller/vendor (vendeur), hawker (vendeur ambulant), stall (étal), market square (place du marché), price (prix), change (la monnaie), receipt (reçu).



A market stall : 1. seller, 2. customer, 3. goods, 4. scale, 5. cash box, 6. stall.

1.2 Asking Prices : How Much Is It ?

When you want to know the price of something, English offers three very common questions. Learn them by heart :

À RETENIR Asking the price

- How much is... ? — used with a singular or uncountable noun : How much is a bunch of plantains ? How much is the palm oil ?
- How much are... ? — used with a plural noun : How much are the tomatoes ?
- How much does it cost ? / How much do they cost ? — How much does this dress cost ?
- What's the price of... ? — What's the price of this dried fish ?

Answers : It's 1,500 FCFA. / They're 500 FCFA. / It costs 2,000 FCFA.

ATTENTION Common mistake

Never say "How much costs..." or "How much it costs?" In English questions, you need the auxiliary does/do : How much does it cost ? Also remember : How much is (singular) but How much are (plural).

1.3 Polite Requests and Partitive Articles (Grammar)

PROPRIÉTÉ Polite Requests : Asking and Offering

In a market context, being polite helps the transaction. We use three main structures :

- Could you + bare infinitive... ? (Polite request) — Could you give me a bunch of plantains?
- Can you + bare infinitive... ? (Less formal request) — Can you reduce the price?
- Let me + bare infinitive (Offering to do something) — Let me help you with that bag.
- May I / Can I + bare infinitive... ? (Asking permission) — May I have a cup of groundnuts?

Note : Let me is followed by the bare infinitive (without to). Could/Can/May are modals followed by bare infinitive.

DÉFINITION Partitive Articles / Quantifiers (Containers)

When buying uncountable goods (rice, oil, groundnuts) or items sold in groups, we use a **partitive structure** : Container/Quantity word + of + Noun.

Container / Quantity	Example	Container / Quantity	Example
a bunch of	a bunch of plantains / bananas	a cup of	a cup of groundnuts / rice / beans
a bottle of	a bottle of palm oil / water / soda	a piece of	a piece of dried fish / meat / soap
a kilo of / kg of	a kilo of tomatoes / onions / maize	a bag of	a bag of rice / cement / flour
a tin of	a tin of tomatoes / milk / sardines	a packet of	a packet of biscuits / sugar / spices

Plural : Two cups of rice, three bottles of oil, five pieces of fish.

ATTENTION Common Mistake : Partitives

Do not say “a groundnuts” or “two rices”. Uncountable nouns need a container : “a cup of groundnuts”, “two cups of rice”. Countable nouns in groups need a collective : “a bunch of plantains”, “two bunches of bananas”.

EXEMPLE From Imperative to Polite Request

Customer (Imperative) : Give me two cups of groundnuts. (Rude)

Customer (Polite) : Could you give me two cups of groundnuts, please? (Standard)

Customer (Polite) : Can I have two cups of groundnuts, please? (Standard)

Seller (Offer) : Let me weigh them for you. (Helpful)

EXERCICE 1 Grammar Practice : Polite Requests and Partitives

Rewrite the following sentences using a polite request structure (Could you..., Can I have..., Let me...) and the correct partitive expression.

1. I want a plantains. (Use : bunch of)
2. Give me the palm oil. (Use : bottle of / Could you)
3. I take two rice. (Use : cups of / Can I have)
4. Help me carry the bag. (Use : Let me)
5. Reduce the price! (Use : Could you)

CORRIGÉ Exercice : Grammar Practice

1. Can I have a bunch of plantains, please? (or Could you give me a bunch of plantains?)
2. Could you give me a bottle of palm oil, please?
3. Can I have two cups of rice, please?
4. Let me help you carry the bag. (or Let me carry the bag for you.)
5. Could you reduce the price, please?

1.4 Bargaining : Discussing the Price**DÉFINITION** Bargaining

Bargaining (marchandage) is the act of discussing the price of something before buying it. The buyer proposes a lower price; the seller accepts, refuses, or proposes another price. In French : négocier le prix.

The customer's expressions (l'acheteur) :

- That's too expensive! (C'est trop cher!)
- Can you reduce the price? (Pouvez-vous baisser le prix?)
- I'll give you 500 FCFA. (Je vous donne 500 FCFA.)
- Is that your last price? (C'est votre dernier prix?)
- Please, add something for me! (Ajoutez-moi quelque chose, s'il vous plaît!)

The seller's expressions (le vendeur) :

- Welcome, dear customer! (Bienvenue, cher client!)
- It's fresh! / It's good quality! (C'est frais! / C'est de bonne qualité!)
- I'm giving you a good price. (Je vous fais un bon prix.)
- Take it or leave it. (À prendre ou à laisser.)
- For you, my friend, 1,200 FCFA — last price! (Pour vous, 1 200 FCFA, dernier prix!)

Concluding the transaction (conclure la transaction) :

- Here's your change. (Voici votre monnaie.)
- Thank you, come again! (Merci, revenez!)
- Thank you very much. Have a nice day! (Merci beaucoup, bonne journée!)

LESAVAIS-TU ? Bargaining in Cameroon

In Cameroon, bargaining is an expected cultural practice in markets like Mokolo (Yaoundé) or the Central Market of Douala. If you accept the first price immediately, the seller may be surprised! On the contrary, in supermarkets (like Santa Lucia or Mahima), prices are fixed — bargaining is not possible. Knowing when to bargain is part of economic life!

1.5 Guided Dialogue : At Mokolo Market

Read this dialogue aloud with a classmate. Amina (A) is the customer ; Mrs. Ndi (B) is the seller from Bamenda.

EXEMPLE Dialogue : Buying plantains and groundnuts

B : Welcome, dear customer! What do you want today?
 A : Good morning, Madam. How much is a bunch of plantains?
 B : It's 1,500 FCFA. It's very fresh!
 A : That's too expensive! Can you reduce the price? I'll give you 1,200 FCFA.
 B : No, my dear. But for you, 1,300 FCFA — last price!
 A : OK, I take it. And how much is a cup of groundnuts?
 B : A cup is 200 FCFA.
 A : Fine. Could you give me two cups, please?

B : Here you are. That's 1,700 FCFA, please.

A : Here is 2,000 FCFA.

B : Here's your change : 300 FCFA. Thank you, come again!

A : Thank you, Madam. Have a nice day!

Item (article)	First price (FCFA)	Final price (FCFA)
a bunch of plantains	1,500	1,300
two cups of groundnuts	400	400
Total paid	1,900	1,700
Money given / change	2,000	300

MÉTHODE How to lead a buying dialogue in 5 steps

1. Greeting (saluer) : Good morning! / Welcome, dear customer!
2. Asking (demander le prix) : How much is...? / What's the price of...?
3. Bargaining (négocier) : That's too expensive! Can you take 1,200?
4. Paying (payer) : Here is 2,000 FCFA. — Here's your change.
5. Thanking (remercier) : Thank you, come again! / Have a nice day!

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 1 Mini-dialogue with numbers

Complete the dialogue with the correct expressions.

A : How much a bottle of palm oil?

B : It's 2,500 FCFA.

A : That's expensive! Can you the price? I'll give you 2,000 FCFA.

B : OK, for you, 2,200 FCFA. Take it or it!

A : Fine, I take it. Here is 2,500 FCFA.

B : Here's your : 300 FCFA. Thank you, come again!

SOLUTION

Solution : A : How much is a bottle of palm oil? B : It's 2,500 FCFA. A : That's too expensive! Can you reduce the price? I'll give you 2,000 FCFA. B : OK, for you, 2,200 FCFA. Take it or leave it! A : Fine, I take it. Here is 2,500 FCFA. B : Here's your change : 300 FCFA. Thank you, come again!

Check the calculation : $2\,500 - 2\,200 = 300$ FCFA of change. Correct!

EXERCICE 2 Role-play : At the Central Market of Douala

Work in pairs. Student A is the customer, Student B is the seller. Build a dialogue using the 5-step method. The customer must buy a cup of groundnuts (200 FCFA), three tomatoes (250 FCFA) and a piece of dried fish (1,000 FCFA). The customer must bargain at least once and pay with 2,000 FCFA. Then change roles.

CORRIGÉ Exercice : role-play

Model dialogue :

B : Welcome, dear customer! What do you need?

A : Good morning. How much is a cup of groundnuts?

B : It's 200 FCFA.

A : OK. And how much are the tomatoes?

B : Three tomatoes cost 250 FCFA. They're fresh!

A : Fine. What's the price of this dried fish?

B : It's 1,000 FCFA.

A : That's too expensive! Can you reduce the price? I'll give you 800 FCFA.

B : For you, 900 FCFA — last price!

A : OK, I take everything. How much is the total?

B : $200 + 250 + 900 = 1\,350$ FCFA, please.

A : Here is 2,000 FCFA.

B : Here's your change : 650 FCFA. Thank you, come again!

A : Thank you! Have a nice day!

À RETENIR To remember

At the market, master three blocks of language : (1) asking prices — How much is/are...? How much does it cost? ; (2) polite requests & partitives — Could you give me...? Can I have a bunch of...? A cup of... A bottle of... ; (3) bargaining — That's too expensive! Can you reduce the price? ; (4) closing the deal — Here's your change. Thank you, come again! With these tools, Amina — and you — can buy and sell in English at any Cameroonian market.

2 POLITE REQUESTS AND PARTITIVE EXPRESSIONS (GRAMMAR)

In the previous section, you learned the vocabulary of buying and selling at a nearby store or market : foodstuffs, articles, prices and bargaining expressions. But knowing the words is not

enough. When you speak to a customer, a shopkeeper, a teacher or an examiner, how you ask is as important as what you ask. In English, a direct order like « Give me bread » sounds rude and can cost you marks at the Probatoire oral examination. In this section, you will learn two essential grammar tools for the market situation : **polite requests** (Could you... ?, Can you... ?, Please..., Let me...) and **partitive expressions** (a cup of rice, a bunch of plantains...).

2.1 Polite Requests : Could you... ?, Can you... ?, Please...

Intuition : from the market to the classroom

Imagine two customers at Mokolo market in Yaoundé. The first one says : « Give me two kilos of rice! » The second one says : « Could you give me two kilos of rice, please? » Who will get better service? Obviously the second customer. English, like French, has degrees of politeness (des degrés de politesse). The more polite you are, the more you use question forms and modal verbs instead of direct orders.

DÉFINITION Polite request

A **polite request** (requête polie) is a way of asking someone to do something for you without giving a direct order. The main structures are :

- Can you + bare infinitive... ? — informal, friendly (entre amis, registre familier).
- Could you + bare infinitive... ? — polite, standard (forme polie recommandée, registre courant).
- Please + bare infinitive... or Could you..., please? — adding please always increases politeness.

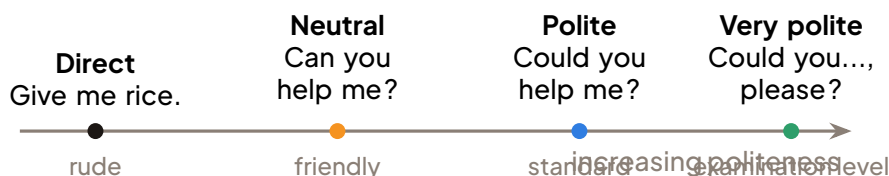
The bare infinitive (infinitif sans to) is the verb in its simple form : give, carry, help, show.

PROPRIÉTÉ The politeness scale

From the least polite to the most polite :

1. Direct order : Give me a bag of flour. (rude, to avoid)
2. Neutral : Can you give me a bag of flour?
3. Polite : Could you give me a bag of flour?
4. Very polite : Could you give me a bag of flour, please?

Could is the past form of can, but here it does not express the past : it expresses politeness and hesitation (politesse et hésitation), which softens the request (adoucit la demande).



The politeness scale : from a direct order (rude) to a very polite request with Could you... please?. At the Probatoire oral exam, always aim at the green level.

EXEMPLE At the store

- Can you show me the price of this shirt ? (to a friend)
- Could you weigh this fish for me ? (to the fishmonger)
- Could you reduce the price, please ? (bargaining politely)
- Please, wrap the meat in paper. (short polite form)

2.2 Suggestions and Offers with Let me + bare infinitive

When you want to offer help (proposer de l'aide) or suggest doing something yourself (suggérer de faire quelque chose soi-même), English uses a very simple and elegant structure.

DÉFINITION Let me + bare infinitive

Let me + bare infinitive is used to offer to do something for someone, or to suggest an action that you will do yourself. It is polite and friendly.

Let me + verb (bare infinitive) + complement.

Examples : Let me help you. / Let me carry your bag. / Let me show you the way to the market.

EXEMPLE Offering help at the market

- Your basket is heavy. Let me carry it for you.
- Let me help you choose the best plantains.
- Let me give you a discount : two tins for 1500 FCFA.

Note : to suggest an action for a group (you and others), use Let's (= let us) : Let's go to

the market! Do not confuse let me (je) with let's (nous).

2.3 Responding to Requests

A request always needs an answer. Here are the standard responses you must master.

Type	Expression	Example
Accepting	Sure! / Of course! / Certainly! / No problem!	— Could you wrap the fish? — Sure!
Accepting (offer)	Yes, please. / Thank you.	— Let me carry your bag. — Thank you!
Refusing politely	I'm sorry, I can't. / I'm afraid not.	— Could you reduce the price? — I'm sorry, I can't; it is already cheap.

ATTENTION Refuse politely

Never answer a request with a dry No. Always soften a refusal : I'm sorry, I can't + a reason if possible. Example : I'm sorry, I can't. The shop is closing. A polite refusal keeps the conversation friendly — and earns marks in speaking tests.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 2 Building a polite dialogue at the market

Énoncé — Complete this dialogue between a customer (A) and a shopkeeper (B) using : Could you, Let me, Sure, I'm sorry, I can't, please.

A :give me a loaf of bread, ?

B :! Here you are. Anything else?

A : Yes.reduce the price of these tomatoes?

B :, They are very fresh. Butadd one more tomato for free.

A : Thank you very much!

SOLUTION

Solution détaillée —

A : Could you give me a loaf of bread, please? (very polite request : question form + please)

B : Sure! Here you are. Anything else? (accepting a request)

A : Yes. Could you reduce the price of these tomatoes? (polite bargaining)

B : I'm sorry, I can't. They are very fresh. But let me add one more tomato for free. (polite refusal + offer with let me)

A : Thank you very much!

2.4 Partitive Expressions : Quantifying Uncountable Nouns

Intuition : the problem of rice and bread

Look at these two sentences : « I bought a rice » and « I bought a cup of rice ». The first one is wrong. Why ? Because rice, bread, oil, flour and meat are **uncountable nouns** (noms indénombrables / non comptables) : you cannot count them directly with a/an or with numbers (one, two...). To quantify them, English uses a container, a unit of measurement or a shape classifier + of.

DÉFINITION Partitive expression

A **partitive expression** (expression partitive / quantificateur) is an expression used to quantify uncountable nouns. Its structure is :

a / number + container / unit / classifier + of + uncountable noun

Examples : a cup of rice, a loaf of bread, two bottles of palm oil, a piece of meat.

MÉTHODE Choosing the right partitive

To choose the correct partitive, follow these steps :

1. Identify the noun : is it countable (egg, tomato, orange) or uncountable (rice, bread, oil, meat, flour) ? If it is countable, simply use a/an or a number.
2. Look at the shape, the container or the standard unit of the foodstuff : a liquid usually comes in a bottle, cup, glass or litre ; bread comes in a loaf ; fruits on a stem come in a bunch ; tinned food comes in a tin ; powder in a bag or packet.
3. Build the expression : a/number + partitive + of + noun. Check the plural : two bottles of oil (the partitive takes the plural, not the uncountable noun).

À RETENIR Essential partitives for the market

Partitive	Used with (examples)
a cup of	rice, beans, gari, groundnuts, sugar
a bunch of	plantains, bananas, carrots, grapes
a loaf of	bread (two loaves of bread)
a bottle of	palm oil, groundnut oil, water, soda
a piece of	meat, fish, soap, chalk, cake
a tin of	sardines, tomato paste, milk, corned beef
a bag of	flour, rice, cement, fertiliser
a packet of	spaghetti, biscuits, tea, sugar, maggi
a kilo of	meat, onions, tomatoes, rice, fish
a litre of	palm oil, kerosene, milk, petrol

Foodstuff (Uncountable)

Partitive Expression

rice, beans, gari

a cup of / a bag of

plantains, bananas

a bunch of

bread

a loaf of

palm oil, water

a bottle of / a litre of

meat, fish

a piece of / a kilo of

sardines, tomato paste

a tin of

flour, cement

a bag of / a packet of

Mapping diagram : each uncountable foodstuff (left) connects to its correct partitive expression(s) (right). The partitive reflects the shape, container or standard unit of the product.

EXEMPLE A complete shopping sentence

Could you give me two bottles of palm oil and three tins of sardines, please?

Observe the numbers : the partitive becomes plural (bottles, tins), but the uncountable nouns (palm oil, sardines as a product category) never take -s in this structure. Compare : a bag of flour → five bags of flour (never flours).

ATTENTION The most frequent mistake

Do not say « a rice », « a bread » or « an oil ». Uncountable nouns never take a/an directly. Always use a partitive expression :

- Wrong : I want a bread. → Right : I want a loaf of bread.
- Wrong : She bought a rice. → Right : She bought a cup of rice / a bag of rice.
- Wrong : Give me an oil. → Right : Give me a bottle of oil / a litre of oil.

Also remember : bread has no plural (breads does not exist in standard English); count loaves : three loaves of bread.

LES AVAIS-TU ? Could you vs Can you at the exam

Did you know? Could you is more polite than Can you, and examiners at the Probatoire and Baccalauréat technique oral examinations pay close attention to politeness. A candidate who says Could you repeat the question, please? immediately shows mastery of polite interaction. In Cameroonian markets, politeness also has economic value : a polite customer often gets a bonus (a small extra quantity for free, called « un petit plus » or « arrondi »)!

2.5 Practice : From Impolite to Polite

EXERCICE 3 Make it polite

Rewrite these impolite sentences as polite requests, using Could you...? or Could you..., please?.

1. Give me a kilo of meat.
2. Show me your tomatoes.
3. Wrap the fish in paper.
4. Carry my bag.
5. Reduce the price of this shirt.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 1

1. Could you give me a kilo of meat, please?
2. Could you show me your tomatoes?
3. Could you wrap the fish in paper, please?
4. Could you carry my bag, please? (or, to offer help : Let me carry your bag.)
5. Could you reduce the price of this shirt, please?

EXERCICE 4 Choose the right partitive

Complete with : a bunch of, a loaf of, a bottle of, a tin of, a bag of, a cup of, a piece of, a litre of.

1. My mother boughtplantains at the market.
2. Please give mebread for breakfast.
3. We needpalm oil to cook eru.
4. He drankwater after the football match.
5. The carpenter boughtflour for his wife.
6. I atemeat with my fufu.
7. She sellsrice for 200 FCFA.
8. Opensardines for the sandwich.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 2

1. a bunch of plantains
2. a loaf of bread
3. a bottle of palm oil (or a litre of)
4. a litre of water (or a bottle of)
5. a bag of flour
6. a piece of meat
7. a cup of rice (or a bag of)
8. a tin of sardines

EXERCICE 5 Numbers and partitives

Put the partitive in the plural where necessary.

1. three (tin)of sardines
2. two (loaf)of bread
3. five (cup)of rice
4. four (bottle)of palm oil

CORRIGÉ Exercice 3

1. three tins of sardines
2. two loaves of bread (irregular plural : loaf → loaves)
3. five cups of rice
4. four bottles of palm oil

Remember : the uncountable noun never changes; only the partitive takes the plural mark.

À RETENIR Key points of this section

- Politeness scale : Give me... (rude) < Can you...? < Could you...? < Could you..., please?
- Offer help with Let me + bare infinitive : Let me help you.
- Accept : Sure! / Of course! — Refuse politely : I'm sorry, I can't.
- Uncountable nouns (rice, bread, oil, meat, flour) need a partitive expression : a cup of rice, a loaf of bread, two bottles of palm oil.
- The plural mark goes on the partitive, never on the uncountable noun.

You can now ask for anything at the market politely and quantify any foodstuff correctly. In the next section, Managing Personal Finances, you will use these skills in listening activities about money, and discover a new grammar point : adjectives used as nouns and the short answers So do I and Neither did he.

3 MANAGING PERSONAL FINANCES (LISTENING & GRAMMAR)

3.1 Transition from Polite Requests to Financial Conversations

In the previous section, we learned how to make **polite requests** at the market using structures like “Could you give me a kilo of rice?” or “Let me pay now, please.” We also studied **partitive articles** to talk about quantities : a bunch of bananas, a cup of tea, a loaf of bread.

Now we move from buying to managing the money that makes those purchases possible. In daily life – whether you are a student, an apprentice, a shop owner or a farmer – you must **plan your income, control your expenses, and save for the future**. This section gives you the English tools to listen to, talk about, and write about personal and small-business finances in the

Cameroonian context.

DÉFINITION Budget

A budget is a plan that shows how much money you earn (income) and how you will spend it (expenses) over a given period (week, month, year). It helps you avoid debt and build savings.

LESAVAIS-TU ? La tontine (njangi) au Cameroun

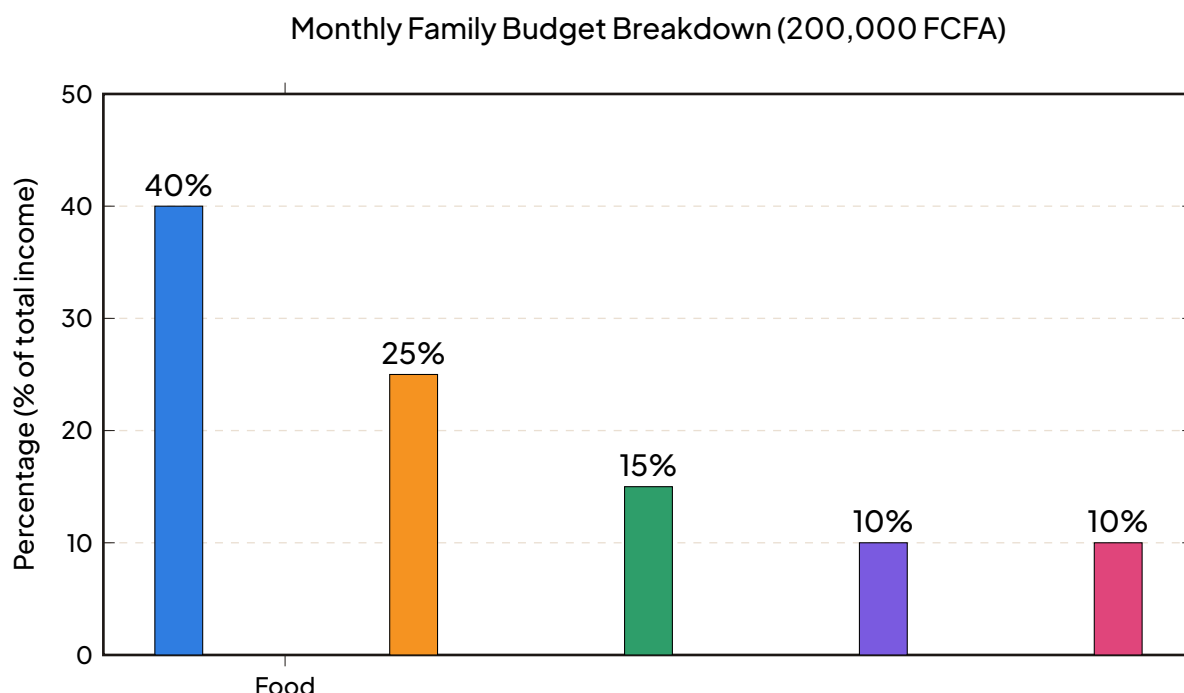
La tontine (appelée njangi en pidgin/anglais camerounais) est un système d'épargne rotative très répandu. Un groupe de personnes (collègues, voisins, membres d'une église) cotise chaque semaine ou chaque mois. À tour de rôle, chaque membre reçoit la totalité de la cagnotte. Cela permet d'accéder à des sommes importantes sans passer par la banque. On trouve des tontines aussi bien en milieu rural qu'urbain, et de plus en plus via Mobile Money (MTN MoMo, Orange Money).

3.2 Key Vocabulary : Personal and Small-Business Finances

English term	Meaning / French gloss	Example in context
income	revenus (salaire, gains, recettes)	My monthly income is 150,000 FCFA.
expenses	dépenses (loyer, nourriture, transport, frais scolaires)	She writes down all her expenses in a notebook.
budget	budget (plan de revenus et de dépenses)	We must stick to our budget this month.
savings	épargne (argent mis de côté)	His savings helped him buy a new sewing machine.
debt	dette (argent dû)	He is trying to pay off his debt to the supplier.
loan	prêt (emprunt bancaire ou entre particuliers)	She took a loan to expand her shop.
tontine / njangi	tontine (épargne rotative communautaire)	Our tontine meets every Friday at 6 p.m.
mobile money / MoMo	argent mobile (MTN MoMo, Orange Money)	I sent the money via MoMo.
interest	intérêt (taux d'intérêt)	The loan has a 5% interest rate.
repay	rembourser	He repays 10,000 FCFA every month.
to stick to	respecter, s'en tenir à (un budget)	You must stick to your budget.
to make ends meet	joindre les deux bouts	With rising prices, it's hard to make ends meet.

3.3 Listening : Managing a Family Budget

Before you listen : Look at the bar chart below. It shows the typical monthly budget of a Cameroonian family earning **200,000 FCFA**. Try to guess the percentage for each category.



Répartition type d'un budget familial mensuel de 200 000 FCFA. Source : estimation basée sur enquêtes ménages Cameroun (INS, données publiques).

Audio script (Teacher reads aloud / played from device) :

Dialogue 1 : At the kitchen table Mother: "Paul, let's look at this month's budget. Our **income** is 200,000 FCFA : my salary 120,000 and your father's 80,000." Father : "Right. **Food** takes 40% – that's 80,000 FCFA. **School fees** for the three children are 25%, so 50,000 FCFA." Mother: "**Transport** to work and school is 15% – 30,000 FCFA. We put 10% into **savings** – 20,000 FCFA – through our **tontine**." Father : "The remaining 10% (20,000 FCFA) covers **others** : electricity, water, medicine, airtime. We have no **debt** this month because we repaid the **loan** for the roof last month." Mother: "Good. But prices are rising. We must **stick to the budget**."

Dialogue 2 : Small business owner Alice (tailor): "I earn about 180,000 FCFA a month from sewing. My **expenses** : rent 40,000, electricity 10,000, fabric and thread 50,000, transport 15,000. That's 115,000 FCFA. I save 30,000 in my **MoMo** account and put 20,000 in the **tontine**. The rest (15,000) is for food and emergencies. I took a small **loan** of 100,000 FCFA to buy a new machine ; I **repay** 10,000 monthly with 2% **interest**."

Listening comprehension exercises :

EXERCICE 6 Extracting numerical information

Listen to Dialogue 1 and complete the table.

Category	Percentage	Amount (FCFA)
Income (total)	100%	-----
Food	40%	-----
School fees	-----	50,000
Transport	15%	-----
Savings (tontine)	-----	20,000
Others	10%	-----
Debt / Loan repayment	0%	0

CORRIGÉ Exercice 1

Category	Percentage	Amount (FCFA)
Income (total)	100%	200,000
Food	40%	80,000
School fees	25%	50,000
Transport	15%	30,000
Savings (tontine)	10%	20,000
Others	10%	20,000
Debt / Loan repayment	0%	0

EXERCICE 7 True / False / Not Mentioned – Dialogue 2

Listen to Dialogue 2 and decide.

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------|
| 1. Alice earns 200,000 FCFA a month. | [True / False / Not Mentioned] |
| 2. Her biggest expense is rent. | [True / False / Not Mentioned] |
| 3. She saves money in two different ways. | [True / False / Not Mentioned] |
| 4. The loan interest rate is 5%. | [True / False / Not Mentioned] |
| 5. She repays the loan over 10 months. | [True / False / Not Mentioned] |

CORRIGÉ Exercice 2

1. False (she earns 180,000 FCFA)
2. False (fabric and thread 50,000 > rent 40,000)
3. True (MoMo account + tontine)
4. False (2% interest)
5. True ($100,000 \div 10,000 = 10$ months)

3.4 Grammar 1 : Adjectives Used as Nouns (The + Adjective)

When we talk about **groups of people** in society, we often use **the + adjective** as a plural noun. The verb is **plural**.

PROPRIÉTÉ The + adjective = a group of people

Structure : the + adjective (no noun after it) → plural verb.

Examples : the rich, the poor, the young, the old / the elderly, the unemployed, the homeless, the disabled, the sick.

EXEMPLE Adjectives as nouns in financial contexts

- The rich invest in land and businesses. (Les riches investissent...)
- The poor struggle to make ends meet. (Les pauvres peinent...)
- The unemployed need access to micro-loans. (Les chômeurs ont besoin...)
- The elderly receive a small pension. (Les personnes âgées touchent...)
- The young prefer Mobile Money for savings. (Les jeunes préfèrent...)

ATTENTION Piège fréquent

Ne dites pas "The poors struggle..." ou "The riches invest...". L'adjectif ne prend jamais de -s. C'est the poor, the rich, the unemployed (pluriel de sens, singulier de forme).

3.5 Grammar 2 : Agreement Structures – So do I / Neither did he

In conversations about money habits, we often want to say "Me too" or "Me neither" in a gram-

matically correct way. English uses **inversion** with the **auxiliary verb**.

PROPRIÉTÉ So / Neither + auxiliary + subject

- Affirmative agreement : So + auxiliary + subject
"I save every month." → "So do I." (Moi aussi.)
- Negative agreement : Neither (or Nor) + auxiliary + subject
"He didn't repay the loan." → "Neither did she." (Elle non plus.)

The auxiliary matches the tense and polarity of the first sentence.

First speaker (tense)	Auxiliary used	So + aux + subject	Neither + aux + subject
Present Simple (I save)	do / does	So do I. / So does she.	Neither do I. / Neither does he.
Past Simple (I saved)	did	So did I.	Neither did I.
Present Continuous (I am saving)	am / is / are	So am I.	Neither am I.
Past Continuous (I was saving)	was / were	So was I.	Neither was I.
Present Perfect (I have saved)	have / has	So have I.	Neither have I.
Future with will (I will save)	will	So will I.	Neither will I.
Modal can (I can save)	can	So can I.	Neither can I.
Modal should (I should save)	should	So should I.	Neither should I.
be as main verb (I am careful)	am / is / are	So am I.	Neither am I.

EXEMPLE Concrete examples from financial dialogues

- A : "I save 5,000 FCFA every month."
B : "So do I." (Present Simple → do)
- A : "My sister uses MoMo for her tontine."
B : "So does mine." (3^e personne sg → does)
- A : "We didn't borrow money last year."
B : "Neither did we." (Past Simple négatif → did)
- A : "He hasn't repaid his debt yet."
B : "Neither have I." (Present Perfect négatif → have)
- A : "I can't afford a new machine now."
B : "Neither can I." (Modal can't → can)
- A : "She is very careful with money."
B : "So am I." (be verbe principal → am)

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 3 Choosing the correct agreement

Complete each response with So or Neither + the correct auxiliary + subject.

1. "I keep a daily expense notebook." → _____ I.
2. "My brother doesn't have a bank account." → _____ I.
3. "We paid our tontine contribution yesterday." → _____ we.
4. "She hasn't received her salary yet." → _____ he.
5. "They will invest in a new freezer." → _____ we.
6. "He can't read the contract." → _____ she.
7. "I am worried about inflation." → _____ I.
8. "We weren't able to save last month." → _____ they.

Solution :

1. So do I (Present Simple affirmatif)
2. Neither do I (Present Simple négatif doesn't → do)
3. So did we (Past Simple affirmatif)
4. Neither has he (Present Perfect négatif hasn't → has)
5. So will we (Future will)
6. Neither can she (Modal can't)
7. So am I (be verbe principal)
8. Neither were they (Past be négatif weren't)

ATTENTION Erreur très fréquente : "So I do" vs "So do I"

- "So do I." = Accord : "Moi aussi, j'épargne." (Structure inversée : auxiliaire + sujet)
- "So I do." = Prise de conscience / confirmation : "Effectivement, c'est vrai !" (Ordre normal : sujet + auxiliaire).
Exemple : A : "You save 10,000 a month!" B : "So I do!" (Ah oui, c'est vrai! Je ne m'en rendais pas compte.)

Au Probatoire / Bac : Pour exprimer l'accord, l'inversion est obligatoire. "So I do" sera considéré comme une erreur.

3.6 Grammar 3 : Reacting to Statements about Cameroonian Financial Habits

Pair work / Whole class activity. Read each statement. Student A says the statement. Student B responds with So... or Neither... using the correct auxiliary, **according to their own reality**. Then swap roles.

1. "Most young people in my neighbourhood **use** Mobile Money for savings."
2. "The **unemployed** **find** it hard to get a bank loan."
3. "My parents **didn't have** a tontine when they were young."
4. "I **have never borrowed** money from a microfinance institution."
5. "The **elderly prefer** keeping cash at home."
6. "We **should** teach budgeting in secondary school."
7. "Inflation **has increased** food prices a lot this year."
8. "I **am** good at sticking to my budget."
9. "My sister **can** manage a small business account."
10. "We **weren't** taught personal finance at primary school."

EXEMPLE Model exchange

Student A : "Most young people in my neighbourhood use Mobile Money for savings."

Student B : "So do my friends." (ou "Neither do mine." si ce n'est pas le cas)

Student A : "The unemployed find it hard to get a bank loan."

Student B : "So do the young graduates I know."

Student A : "My parents didn't have a tontine when they were young."

Student B : "Neither did mine."

3.7 Integrated Practice : Listening + Grammar + Vocabulary

Task : Listen to a short monologue (teacher reads). Take notes on **numbers** and **habits**. Then write **4 sentences** reacting with So / Neither.

Monologue (Teacher reads) :

"My name is Ngono. I am a mechanic in Douala. I earn 150,000 FCFA per month. I spend 60,000 on food, 30,000 on rent, 15,000 on transport, and 10,000 on airtime and electricity. I save 20,000 in my tontine every month. I have a loan of 200,000 FCFA for my tools ; I repay 15,000 monthly. I don't have a bank account. I use Orange Money. The rich in my area buy land ; the poor struggle daily. I am careful with money. I will open a bank account next year."

EXERCICE 8 Note-taking + Grammar reaction

1. Fill the table while listening.

Item	Amount (FCFA)
Income	
Food	
Rent	
Transport	
Airtime / Electricity	
Savings (tontine)	
Loan repayment	
Total expenses	
Remaining?	

2. Write 4 reactions using So / Neither + auxiliary + I / we / my brother / etc. based on your own situation.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 3 – Note-taking

Item	Amount (FCFA)
Income	150,000
Food	60,000
Rent	30,000
Transport	15,000
Airtime / Electricity	10,000
Savings (tontine)	20,000
Loan repayment	15,000
Total expenses	150,000
Remaining	0

Reactions (examples) :

1. "I earn 150,000 FCFA." → Neither do I. (ou So do I. selon votre cas)
2. "I save 20,000 in my tontine." → So do I.
3. "I don't have a bank account." → Neither do I.
4. "I am careful with money." → So am I.

3.8 Summary of Key Points

À RETENIR Ce qu'il faut retenir de cette section

- Vocabulaire finances : income, expenses, budget, savings, debt, loan, tontine/njangi, mobile money (MoMo), interest, repay, stick to a budget, make ends meet.
- Adjectifs nominalisés : the rich, the poor, the unemployed, the elderly, the young + verbe au pluriel. Pas de -s à l'adjectif.
- Accord affirmatif : So + auxiliaire + sujet (inversion). Ex : So do I. / So does she. / So did we.
- Accord négatif : Neither (ou Nor) + auxiliaire + sujet (inversion). Ex : Neither did he. / Neither can I. / Neither have they.
- Auxiliaire = celui de la phrase originale (do/does, did, be, have/has, will, can, should...).
- Piège : So I do ≠ accord. C'est une confirmation surprise. Pour l'accord : inversion obligatoire.
- Contexte camerounais : tontine, Mobile Money, petits commerces, budget familial, inflation.

3.9 Homework / Autonomous Practice

EXERCICE 9 Written production

Write a short paragraph (80–100 words) about your personal budget or that of someone you know. Use at least 6 vocabulary items from the list, one adjective-as-noun (the poor, the young...), and two So/Neither structures (invent a friend's statement and your reaction). Example start : "My friend Pierre says he saves 10,000 FCFA a month. So do I. But the unemployed in our area..."

EXERCICE 10 Grammar consolidation

Transform each sentence into an agreement response for the subject in brackets.

1. "I track my expenses daily." (she) → _____
2. "He hasn't paid his tontine." (they) → _____
3. "We will use MoMo for the next contribution." (I) → _____
4. "She was surprised by the interest rate." (he) → _____

5. "They can't afford a new fridge." (we) → _____
6. "My brother doesn't know how to make a budget." (I) → _____

CORRIGÉ Exercice 5

1. So does she.
2. Neither have they.
3. So will I.
4. So was he.
5. Neither can we.
6. Neither do I.

4 DETERMINERS AND QUANTIFIERS — PARTS 1, 2 & 3 (GRAMMAR)

In the previous section, we listened to texts about managing personal finances. We heard sentences like : "I spend some money on food, but I don't have any money left at the end of the month." and "How much money do you save every week?" Words like **some**, **any**, **much** and **every** are called **quantifiers**. They tell us how much or how many of something there is. In this section, we will master them step by step, because they are essential for talking about money, prices, goods at the market, and trades.

4.1 What is a Quantifier ?

DÉFINITION Quantifier

A **quantifier** is a word or group of words placed before a noun to express its quantity (how much or how many), without giving an exact number. Examples : some, any, much, many, few, little, all, most, each, every, both, no, none.

Before choosing a quantifier, you must know whether the noun is :

- **Countable** (dénombrable) : it has a plural form and can be counted — one trader, two traders ; a mango, three mangoes.
- **Uncountable** (indénombrable) : it has no plural form and cannot be counted directly — money, rice, water, information, furniture, advice. We count them with partitive expressions : a

bag of rice, a glass of water.

ATTENTION The golden rule

Never say “many money” or “much mangoes”. First ask yourself : Can I count this noun ? Then choose the correct quantifier.

4.2 Part 1 : some (of), any (of), much, all (of), most (of)

1. **Some and any.** Both are used with plural countable nouns and with uncountable nouns. The difference depends on the type of sentence :

Quantifier	Use	Example
some	Affirmative sentences ; offers and requests (when we expect “yes”)	I bought some tomatoes. / Would you like some tea? / Can I have some change?
any	Negative sentences and most questions	She doesn't have any customers today. / Do you have any groundnuts?
much	Uncountable nouns, mainly in negatives and questions	We don't have much time. / How much money do you need?
all (of)	The whole quantity : 100 %	All the traders pay taxes. / He spent all of his salary.
most (of)	The majority : more than half	Most shopkeepers open early. / Most of the rice is sold.

2. **Some vs. some of.** Use some + noun for a general quantity : Some students like accounting. Use some of + the/these/my + noun for a part of a specific group : Some of the students in my class want to become electricians. The same logic applies to any of, much of, all of, most of : the word **of** appears when the noun is made specific by the, this, that, these, those or a possessive (my, his, our).

EXEMPLE At the market in Douala

“Madam, do you have any fresh fish today?” — “Yes, I have some mackerel, but I don't have much left. Most of it was sold this morning. Would you like some?”

4.3 Part 2 : few / a few (of) and little / a little (of)

This is one of the most delicate points of English grammar, because the small word **a** completely changes the meaning.

PROPRIÉTÉ Negative vs. positive meaning

- **few** + plural countable and **little** + uncountable have a negative meaning : “presque pas, très peu” — the quantity is insufficient or disappointing.
- **a few** + plural countable and **a little** + uncountable have a positive meaning : “quelques-uns, un peu” — the quantity is small but enough.

Compare these sentences carefully :

- **Few** customers came to my shop today, so I am worried. (presque pas de clients → situation négative)
- **A few** customers came to my shop today, so I made some profit. (quelques clients → situation positive)
- There is **little** money in my account ; I cannot buy the machine. (presque pas d’argent)
- There is **a little** money in my account ; I can buy some tools. (un peu d’argent, c’est suffisant)

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 4 Choosing between few, a few, little, a little

Complete : “The young carpenter has ... experience, so his father still supervises his work.”
Then : “Fortunately, he has ... good tools, so he can start working.”

SOLUTION

Solution. Experience is uncountable and the meaning is negative (he still needs supervision), so we use little : “The young carpenter has little experience...”. Tools is countable plural and the meaning is positive (“fortunately”), so we use a few : “...he has a few good tools...”.

4.4 Part 3 : each, every, many, much, how many/how much, both (of), no, none (of)

1. Each and every. Both mean “chaque” and both are followed by a **singular noun** and a **singular verb**. Each insists on the individuals one by one (often for a small, precise group) ; every insists on the whole group (often for large numbers or habits) : Each apprentice received a certificate. / Every shop in this street opens at 7 a.m.

ATTENTION Frequent error

Each and **every** are always followed by a singular noun and a singular verb : Each student has a uniform. and NOT Each students have a uniform. Similarly : Every trader pays a tax.

2. Many and much. **Many** goes with countable plurals ; **much** goes with uncountables. Both are common in questions and negatives ; in affirmative sentences, prefer a lot of : There are a lot of

customers today. (more natural than There are many customers today.)

3. **How many vs. how much.** This distinction is essential at the market.

MÉTHODE Choosing between How many and How much

1. Identify the noun after the question.
2. Ask : can I count it ? (one egg, two eggs?)
3. If yes (countable plural) → use **How many** : How many eggs do you want ?
4. If no (uncountable) → use **How much** : How much rice do you need ?
5. Special case : for prices, always use How much : How much is this bag of rice? — It costs 25,000 FCFA.

4. **Both (of), no, none (of).**

- **Both (of)** + plural noun + plural verb = “les deux” : Both (of the) mechanics work in Bonabéri.
- **No** + noun = “aucun, pas de” : There is no bread left. / No customer came.
- **None (of)** replaces a noun or introduces a group : “How many apprentices came?” — “None.” / None of the traders accepted less than 2,000 FCFA for the bag of rice. Note : none of + plural noun can take a singular or plural verb in modern English (None of the shops is/are open), but the singular is preferred in formal writing.

ATTENTION No vs. none

No is always followed by a noun (no money) ; **none** is never followed directly by a noun — it stands alone or uses none of : None of the money was stolen. Never say “none money”.

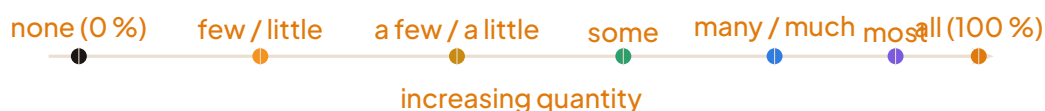
4.5 Summary Table and the Scale of Quantity

The following table summarises all the quantifiers of this lesson according to the type of noun.

Quantifier	Countable (plural)	Uncountable	Meaning / use
some (of)	yes	yes	affirmative, offers
any (of)	yes	yes	negatives, questions
much	no	yes	negatives, questions
many	yes	no	“beaucoup de” (countable)
all (of)	yes	yes	100 %
most (of)	yes	yes	the majority
a few (of)	yes	no	“quelques-uns” (positive)
few	yes	no	“presque pas” (negative)
a little (of)	no	yes	“un peu” (positive)
little	no	yes	“presque pas” (negative)
each / every	singular only	no	“chaque” + singular verb
both (of)	yes (two items)	no	“les deux”
no	yes	yes	+ noun, “aucun”
none (of)	yes	yes	without noun or + of

Summary table : quantifiers classified by type of noun (countable / uncountable) and meaning.

The scale below shows the progression of quantity from zero to totality. It will help you choose the right word when you speak about stock, customers or money.



The scale of quantity : from none (nothing) to all (the totality). Remember : few/little feel negative, a few/a little feel positive.

4.6 Guided Practice in Context

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 5 At Nkoulouloun Market, Douala

Complete the dialogue with : some, any, much, many, a few, little, every, most of, how much, both.

A : Good morning, madam. Do you have (1) ... fresh tomatoes ?

B : Yes, I have (2) ..., but not (3) ... — (4) ... my stock was sold this morning.

A : (5) ... is a kilo ?

B : 500 FCFA. (6) ... trader here sells at the same price.

A : I only have (7) ... money left, so I will take (8) ... kilos.

B : (9) ... my tomatoes and my peppers are fresh. Take (10) ... peppers too!

SOLUTION

Solution. (1) any (question) — (2) some (affirmative) — (3) many (countable plural, negative) — (4) Most of (the majority of a specific stock : most of + possessive) — (5) How much (price) — (6) Every (singular noun trader) — (7) little (uncountable, negative meaning : almost no money) — (8) a few (countable plural, positive) — (9) Both (two categories) — (10) some (offer).

EXERCICE 11 Quantifiers in the world of trades

Choose the correct quantifier.

1. Each / Every apprentice in the workshop has / have his own toolbox.
2. There is few / little electricity in the workshop today, so the machines are off.
3. How many / How much does this second-hand sewing machine cost ?
4. None of / No the customers complained about the price.
5. The tailor has a few / a little regular clients, so his business is doing well.
6. I don't have some / any change. Can you pay with mobile money ?

CORRIGÉ Exercice : Quantifiers in the world of trades

1. Each (or Every) apprentice ...has — singular noun and singular verb after each/every.
2. little — electricity is uncountable, and the meaning is negative (machines are off).
3. How much — for prices we always use how much.
4. None of — none of + the + plural noun ; no would need a noun directly (No customer complained).
5. a few — clients is countable plural and the meaning is positive (business is doing well).
6. any — negative sentence.

LESAVAIS-TU ? Quantifiers at the Probatoire technique

At the Probatoire and Baccalauréat technique, quantifiers appear every year in the grammar (structure) section of the English paper : gap-fill exercises with some/any, much/many, few/a few, and error-correction items with each/every + singular. Mastering the summary table of this lesson guarantees you easy marks !

À RETENIR Key points to remember

- A **quantifier** expresses the quantity of a noun; first check if the noun is countable or uncountable.
- **some** in affirmatives and offers ; **any** in negatives and questions.
- **few/little** = negative ("presque pas") ; **a few/a little** = positive ("quelques-uns / un peu").
- **Each** and **every** + singular noun + singular verb.
- **How many** + countable ; **How much** + uncountable and for prices.
- **No** + noun ; **none** alone or none of + noun.

5 DEVELOPING INTEREST IN A TRADE OR PROFESSION (READING & VOCABULARY)

In the previous section, we mastered **determiners and quantifiers** (some, any, much, many, few, little, each, every, both, none) to speak accurately about quantities of materials, tools, money or time. We can now say "I have **a few** tools" or "There isn't **much** money left". This precision is vital in technical fields. We now move to the heart of this unit, **Economic Life and Occupations** : we will learn to **read about**, **talk about** and **write about** the path from a young apprentice to a qualified professional in Cameroon. You will acquire the vocabulary of trades and training, practise essential reading techniques (skimming and scanning), and learn structures to express your own professional interests and ambitions.

5.1 Vocabulary : Trades, Professions and Technical Training

Technical education in Cameroon prepares you for specific **trades** (métiers manuels ou techniques) and **professions** (professions). Mastering this vocabulary allows you to describe your own training, understand job offers, and discuss the economic life of your community.

Trade / Profession	Description (FR)	Trade / Profession	Description (FR)
carpenter	menuisier / charpentier	mechanic	mécanicien(ne)
tailor	couturier(ère)	electrician	électricien(ne)
nurse	infirmier(ère)	trader	commerçant(e)
farmer	agriculteur(trice)	hairdresser	coiffeur(euse)
plumber	plombier(ère)	welder	soudeur(euse)

Training Term	Meaning / Context (FR)	Training Term	Meaning / Context (FR)
apprenticeship	apprentissage (chez un patron)	vocational training	formation professionnelle (école/centre)
workshop	atelier (lieu de travail/formation)	skills	compétences, savoir-faire
certificate	certificat, diplôme	CAPIET	Certificat d'Aptitude Professionnelle (enseignement technique)
BT	Brevet de Technicien	BTS	Brevet de Technicien Supérieur
master craftsman	maître artisan (patron formateur)	skilled worker	ouvrier(ère) qualifié(e)

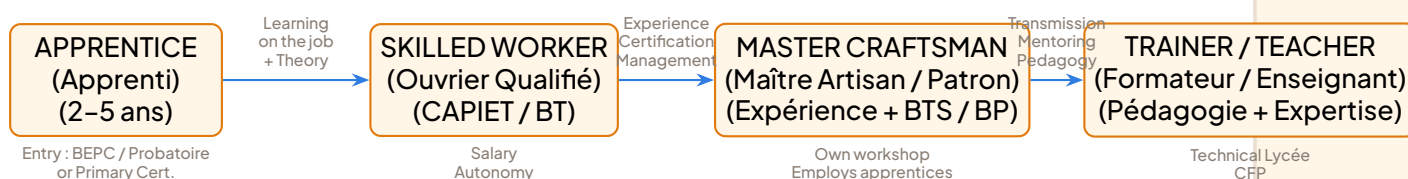
DÉFINITION Apprenticeship

An apprenticeship is a period of learning a trade by working with a skilled person (a master craftsman or mentor) for a fixed time, often combined with theoretical lessons. In Cameroon, it is the main pathway into the informal sector and into many technical careers.

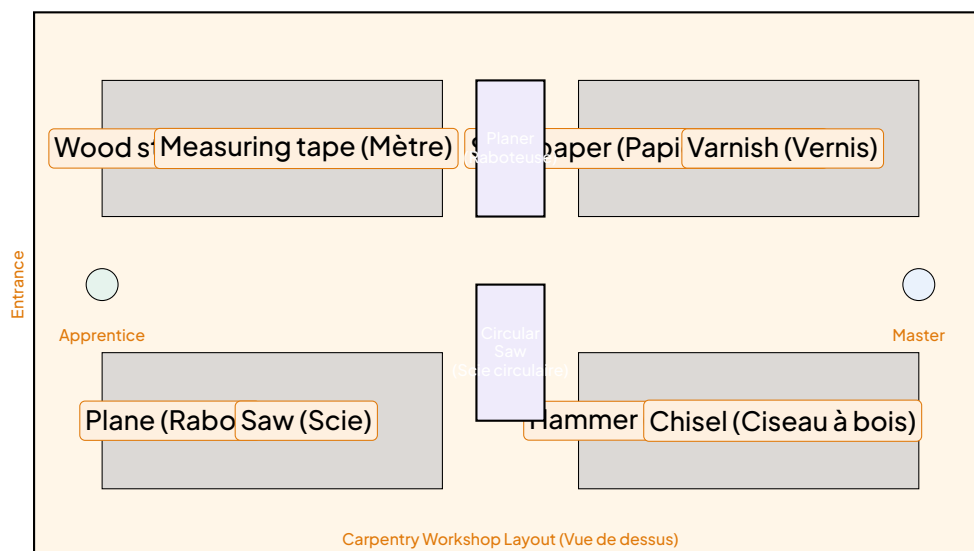
- Apprentice (n.) : the learner (l'apprenti).
- Master craftsman / Mentor (n.) : the trainer (le patron / le maître d'apprentissage).
- Contract (n.) : the agreement defining duration, duties, and pay (le contrat d'apprentissage).

LESAVAIS-TU ? L'apprentissage informel au Cameroun

Saviez-vous qu'une grande majorité des artisans au Cameroun (menuisiers, soudeurs, couturiers, mécaniciens) sont formés par la voie informelle ? Le jeune signe un contrat chez un patron dans un workshop (atelier) pendant 2 à 5 ans. Il apprend on the job (sur le tas), souvent sans passer par un lycée technique. Depuis les années 2000, l'État, à travers le MINEFOP (Ministère de l'Emploi et de la Formation Professionnelle), encourage la certification de ces acquis (CAPIET, BT) pour valoriser ces parcours et faciliter l'insertion professionnelle.



Parcours type de formation professionnelle au Cameroun : de l'apprenti au formateur. Chaque étape valide des compétences (skills) et permet l'accès à la certification (CAPIET, BT, BTS).



Atelier de menuiserie annoté : postes de travail (workbenches), outillage à main (hand tools : plane, saw, chisel, hammer, measuring tape), machines fixes (circular saw, planer), matières premières (wood stock, sandpaper, varnish) et acteurs (apprentice, master).

5.2 Reading Skills : Skimming and Scanning

In technical professional life, you must read quickly : safety manuals, invoices, technical sheets, or professional profiles. Two techniques are essential :

MÉTHODE Reading Comprehension Strategy : Skimming & Scanning

Step 1 : Read the Questions First. Identify keywords (names, dates, places, specific terms like salary, duration, tool, dream). **Step 2 :** Skim for Gist (General Idea). Read the title, the first sentence of each paragraph, and the last sentence. Do not read every word. Ask : "What is this text mainly about ?" **Step 3 :** Scan for Details. Move your eyes fast over the text to locate the keywords from Step 1. Read only the sentences around those keywords. **Step 4 :** Answer Precisely. Write short answers based only on the text. Use your own words if possible. **Step 5 :** Check. Does the answer match the question type (Who ? Where ? How

long? Why?)?

Text 1 : Ngong's Journey in Bafoussam

(Skimming Practice)

EXEMPLE Reading Text 1

Ngong is an eighteen-year-old apprentice carpenter in Bafoussam, the capital of the West Region. He wakes up at 5 :30 a.m. every weekday to reach Master Talla's workshop before 7 :00 a.m. The workshop is located near the main market, a busy place full of noise and dust. Ngong loves the smell of fresh wood and the sound of the planer.

His day starts with sweeping the floor and sharpening tools — chisels, planes, and saws. Then, he watches Master Talla measure and cut expensive mahogany for a client's bedroom set. Ngong is keen on learning how to make dovetail joints, a difficult but strong technique. He says : "I am interested in traditional designs, but I also want to learn modern CNC machines."

In the afternoon, he practises cutting small pieces of scrap wood. He makes mistakes, but Master Talla corrects him patiently. "Patience and precision are the keys," the master often repeats. Ngong dreams of obtaining his CAPIET next year and later his BT at the Technical High School. His ultimate goal is to open his own workshop in Foumban, the city of arts, and train other young apprentices.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 6 Skimming Question

Question : What is the main idea of the text ?

Options : A) The history of Bafoussam market. B) The daily routine and ambitions of an apprentice carpenter. C) How to use a planer machine. D) The price of mahogany wood.

SOLUTION

Solution : Step 1 : Keywords in options : history, market, daily routine, ambitions, planer, price.

Step 2 : Skim the text. Title : "Ngong's Journey". First paragraph : Ngong, 18, apprentice, Bafoussam, workshop. Second paragraph : day starts, sweeping, watching the master, keen on learning, interested in designs. Third paragraph : practises, makes mistakes, dreams of CAPIET, BT, own workshop.

Step 3 : The text covers his routine (sweeping, watching, practising) and his ambitions (CAPIET, BT, own workshop, train others). Options A, C and D are only small details, not the main idea.

Answer : B) The daily routine and ambitions of an apprentice carpenter.

Text 2 : Marie's Tailoring Workshop in Douala

(Scanning Practice)

EXEMPLE Reading Text 2

Marie, 22, works in a busy tailoring workshop in Douala, Akwa district. She completed her apprenticeship three years ago and passed her CAPIET with distinction. Now she is a skilled worker (couturière qualifiée). She earns a good salary and supports her younger brother's school fees.

Marie is passionate about African prints (pagnes) and modern styles. She spends her free time sketching new designs on her phone. She is currently preparing for the BT exam at the Centre de Formation Professionnelle (CFP) in Bonanjo. She attends evening classes three times a week.

Her boss, Madame Ngo, is a master craftsman with 25 years of experience. She encourages Marie to take responsibilities. Last month, Marie managed a big order for a school uniform contract (500 shirts). She organized the cutting, stitching, and finishing teams. The client was satisfied. Marie says : "I dream of becoming a fashion designer and opening a boutique in Bonapriso. I want to share my experience with future apprentices."

EXERCICE 12 Scanning Questions — Text 2

Answer these questions by scanning Text 2. Find the keyword first.

1. What qualification did Marie obtain three years ago? (Keyword : three years ago / qualification)
2. Where does she attend evening classes? (Keyword : evening classes / where)
3. How many shirts were in the school uniform order? (Keyword : shirts / order / number)
4. What is Marie's dream job? (Keyword : dream / becoming)
5. Who is Madame Ngo? (Keyword : Madame Ngo / who)

CORRIGÉ Exercice Scanning

1. The CAPIET (Sentence : "...passed her CAPIET with distinction.")
2. At the CFP in Bonanjo (Sentence : "...preparing for the BT exam at the Centre de Formation Professionnelle (CFP) in Bonanjo.")
3. 500 shirts (Sentence : "...big order for a school uniform contract (500 shirts).")
4. A fashion designer (Sentence : "I dream of becoming a fashion designer...")
5. Marie's boss, a master craftsman (Sentence : "Her boss, Madame Ngo, is a master craftsman with 25 years of experience.")

5.3 Expressing and Sharing Interest in a Trade

To develop a professional network and succeed in interviews or oral exams (Probatoire/Bac technique), you must express your motivation clearly. We use specific structures with gerunds (V-ing) or infinitives.

PROPRIÉTÉ Structures for Expressing Interest

Structure	Example	Traduction
be interested in + V-ing / Noun	I am interested in learning welding.	Je m'intéresse à la soudure / Je veux l'apprendre.
be keen on + V-ing / Noun	She is keen on repairing engines.	Elle adore réparer des moteurs.
dream of + V-ing / Noun	We dream of opening a garage.	Nous rêvons d'ouvrir un garage.
be passionate about + V-ing / Noun	He is passionate about coding.	Il est passionné par le codage.
want / would like / plan + to + Infinitive	I want to become an electrician.	Je veux / Je voudrais / Je prévois de devenir électricien.

ATTENTION Piège Majeur : interested in + V-ing

Erreur fréquente : "I am interested to learn mechanics." (Incorrect!)

Correct : "I am interested in learning mechanics."

Règle : Après une préposition (in, on, of, about, at, to dans look forward to), le verbe prend la forme -ing (gérondif). C'est valable pour keen on, dream of, passionate about, good at, bad at, look forward to.

- Correct : I am keen on driving trucks.
- Correct : He dreams of becoming a nurse.
- Correct : We look forward to starting the internship.

EXEMPLE Profil professionnel type

Ngong, 18, is an apprentice mechanic in Bamenda. He is keen on repairing motorbikes and dreams of opening his own garage. He is passionate about two-stroke engines and interested in taking a BT course next year.

5.4 Sharing Interest : Encouraging Others and Transmitting Skills

A professional does not only work ; they **share** their passion. This creates the next generation of skilled workers.

À RETENIR Language for Sharing & Mentoring

- Encourage others : “You should try carpentry, it’s creative.” / “Why don’t you join the vocational centre?” / “Let me show you how to use this tool.” (Let me + bare infinitive = polite offer/suggestion, seen in Section 2).
- Share experience : “When I was an apprentice, I learned that patience is key.” / “My advice is to practise every day.”
- Train apprentices : “I teach them safety rules first.” / “I supervise their work on the lathe.”

5.5 Integration Activities : Reading, Vocabulary & Writing

EXERCICE 13 Comprehensive Practice

Part A : Vocabulary Matching. Match the terms (1–6) with definitions (a–f).

1. Apprenticeship	a.	A qualified worker who has finished training.
2. Master craftsman	b.	Period of learning a trade with a skilled person.
3. Skilled worker	c.	Official paper proving a qualification (ex : BT).
4. Certificate	d.	Place where practical work is done.
5. Workshop	e.	Expert who trains apprentices.
6. Vocational training	f.	Organized courses to learn a trade.

Part B : Grammar in Context. Complete with the correct form (V-ing or to + infinitive).

1. My brother is interested in _____ (become) a plumber.
2. We plan _____ (open) a new workshop next month.
3. She is keen on _____ (design) clothes.
4. The master asked the apprentice _____ (clean) the machines.
5. I dream of _____ (get) my BTS in Electrotechnics.

Part C : Writing Task (Probatoire Style). Topic : “Write a composition of about 150–180 words on the following subject : You are a young apprentice in a technical trade (carpentry, tailoring, mechanics, etc.). Describe your daily routine, what you like about the trade, your current qualifications (CAPIET, BT preparation), and your professional dream for the future. Use expressions like I am interested in..., I am keen on..., I dream of..., I am passionate about....”

CORRIGÉ Exercice Comprehensive Practice

Part A : 1-b, 2-e, 3-a, 4-c, 5-d, 6-f.

Part B :

1. becoming (interested in + V-ing)
2. to open (plan to + infinitive)
3. designing (keen on + V-ing)
4. to clean (asked somebody to + infinitive)
5. getting (dream of + V-ing)

Part C : Model Composition (Guide) Title : My Path as an Apprentice Electrician

My name is Paul, I am 19 years old, and I am an apprentice electrician in Yaoundé. I have been in this apprenticeship for two years now, working under Master Etoundi in his workshop at Mvog-Ada.

My daily routine starts early. I arrive at 7 :00 a.m. to prepare the tools : testers, pliers, cables, and conduits. I am keen on installing electrical panels because it requires precision and logic. I am also interested in solar energy systems, a growing field in Cameroon. However, the work is hard ; sometimes we work late to finish a wiring contract.

Last year, I obtained my CAPIET with a good grade. Currently, I attend evening classes at the CFP to prepare for the BT exam. I dream of becoming a certified electrical technician specialized in renewable energies. I am passionate about bringing electricity to rural villages.

In the future, I want to open my own company and train young apprentices myself. I believe technical skills are the key to development. As my master says : "A trade in hand finds gold in every land."

6 WRITING ABOUT TRADES AND PROFESSIONS (WRITING & INTEGRATION)

In the previous section, you read texts about young people who developed a strong interest in a trade or profession : a tailor in Yaoundé, a nurse in Bamenda, a mechanic in Douala. You discovered new words such as **apprenticeship** (apprentissage), **vocation** (vocation) and **workshop** (atelier). Now it is your turn to produce language. At the Probatoire technique, writing a clear, well-organised composition is a key skill. This final section teaches you how to write about your dream profession, how to correct a classmate's work, and how to use everything you have learnt in this lesson — buying and selling, polite requests, partitive articles, quantifiers and finance vocabulary — in one complete real-life situation.

6.1 The Structure of a Composition

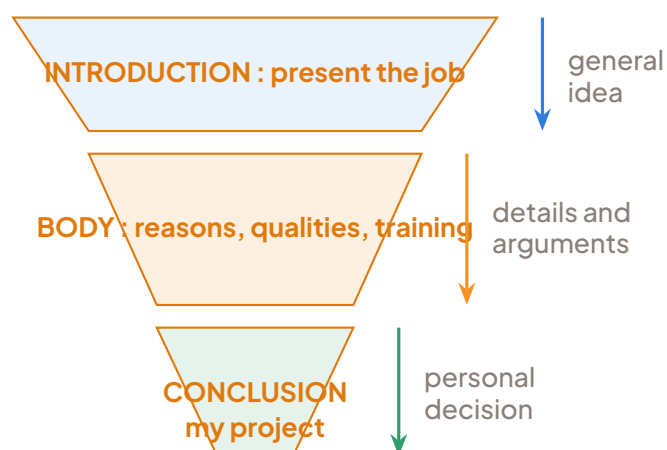
Why structure matters

Imagine you enter a carpenter's workshop. If the tools are everywhere on the floor, you cannot work. A good composition is like a tidy workshop : every idea has its place. Examiners at the Probatoire read hundreds of copies. A composition with a clear plan is easy to read and immediately gets better marks.

DÉFINITION The three parts of a composition

A composition always has three parts :

1. The **introduction** : you present the topic (the trade or profession) and announce your plan.
2. The **body** (development) : two or three paragraphs with your arguments — why you like the job, the qualities required, the training needed.
3. The **conclusion** : you summarise and present your personal project for the future.



The funnel structure of a composition : you move from the general presentation of the profession (wide) to your precise personal project (narrow).

Linking words : the cement of your text

Bricks without cement fall down. Sentences without **linking words** (connecteurs logiques) are difficult to follow. Here are the essential connectors for your compositions :

Function	Linking words
Beginning a list of arguments	first, first of all, to begin with
Adding an idea	moreover, furthermore, also, in addition
Expressing a contrast	however, but, nevertheless
Expressing a result	therefore, so, that is why
Concluding	in conclusion, to sum up, finally

EXEMPLE Linking words in action

First, I want to become an electrician because I like working with my hands. Moreover, electricians earn a good salary in Cameroon. However, the training is long and difficult. Therefore, I must work hard at school. In conclusion, electricity is my passion and my future.

ATTENTION Agreement : the third person trap

The most frequent error at the Probatoire is forgetting the -s of the verb at the third person singular (he, she, it, or a singular noun) :

- Correct : A carpenter works with wood. / My sister wants to be a nurse.
- Wrong : A carpenter work with wood. / She want to be a nurse.

Rule : singular subject + present simple $\Rightarrow$ verb + s. Check every verb when you revise your copy!

6.2 Reusing the Grammar and Vocabulary of the Lesson

A good composition at the Probatoire shows the examiner that you master the lesson. Deliberately reuse :

- **Quantifiers** : **many** young people choose this trade ; **a few** of them succeed immediately ; **most** carpenters learn in a workshop ; **each** apprentice needs patience ; there is **little** unemployment in this sector.
- **Partitive articles** : a **bunch** of tools, a **cup** of garri, a **piece** of advice.
- **Polite requests** : Could you show me your workshop, please? Let me explain my project.
- **Trade vocabulary** : **apprentice** (apprenti), **customer** (client), **salary** (salaire), **skill** (compétence), **training** (formation), **workshop** (atelier), **profit** (bénéfice), **budget** (budget).

EXEMPLE Model plan for “My dream profession”

- Paragraph 1 — The job : name the profession, say what the person does every day. (A mechanic repairs cars and motorbikes...)
- Paragraph 2 — Why I like it : give two or three reasons with first, moreover, furthermore.
- Paragraph 3 — Training needed : school, apprenticeship, qualities required (patient, honest, hard-working).
- Paragraph 4 — My project : your concrete plan for the future (After the Baccalauréat, I will...).

MÉTHODE Five steps to write a composition at the Probatoire

1. Brainstorm : write all your ideas and vocabulary on a draft paper, in any order (5 minutes).
2. Plan : organise the ideas into 3 or 4 paragraphs (introduction, body, conclusion) (5 minutes).
3. Draft : write the composition with linking words ; do not stop for small mistakes (15–20 minutes).
4. Revise : check verb agreements (–s!), quantifiers, spelling and punctuation (5 minutes).
5. Final copy : copy neatly on the exam sheet. A clean copy gives a good impression.

LESAVAIS-TU ? The composition at the Probatoire technique

At the Probatoire and Baccalauréat technique, the composition carries an important part of the English mark. Examiners use criteria : content, organisation, grammar and vocabulary. A clear plan with an introduction, a body and a conclusion already guarantees about half of the organisation points — even before the examiner reads your ideas ! Never write without a plan.

6.3 Guided Writing : “My Dream Profession”

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 7 A model composition

Write a composition of 120–150 words entitled “Why I want to become a tailor”.

SOLUTION

Solution (model answer, 140 words) :

Many young people in my town dream of office jobs, but my dream profession is tailoring. A tailor measures customers, cuts cloth and sews beautiful clothes with a machine.

First, I love this trade because I am creative and I like working with my hands. Moreover, a good tailor has many customers, especially before Christmas and weddings. Furthermore, tailoring does not need much money to start : a few tools, a machine and a small shop are enough. However, the work requires patience, because each customer wants a perfect dress or suit.

To succeed, I need some training. After my Baccalauréat, I will spend two years as an apprentice with Mr Ndi, the best tailor in our quarter. Both of my parents encourage me, and I save a little money every month for my future workshop.

In conclusion, tailoring is a useful and profitable profession. Therefore, I will work hard to open my own shop one day.

Notice : the -s agreements (a tailor measures, cuts, sews), the quantifiers (many, a few, much, each, some, both of, a little) and the connectors (first, moreover, furthermore, however, therefore, in conclusion).

6.4 Peer Correction**DÉFINITION** Peer correction

Peer correction means exchanging and correcting each other's compositions using a checklist (correction entre pairs). You read your classmate's text, you tick the criteria on the grid, and you write one positive comment and one piece of advice. It helps both students : the writer receives feedback, and the reader learns to spot mistakes.

Criterion	Checklist question	Mark /5
Content	Are there clear ideas and reasons about the profession?	
Organisation	Is there an introduction, a body and a conclusion? Are linking words used?	
Grammar	Are verbs correct (-s at the 3rd person)? Are quantifiers used correctly?	
Vocabulary	Are there at least five words about trades and money?	
Total		/20

EXERCICE 14 Peer correction practice

Exchange your composition “My dream profession” with your neighbour.

1. Read the text twice. The first time, read for pleasure ; the second time, use the grid above.
2. Underline in red every verb without -s at the third person.
3. Circle the linking words. If there are fewer than four, give advice.
4. Give a mark out of 20 and write one positive comment and one suggestion.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 1

There is no single answer : the correction depends on each composition. A good peer corrector : (a) ticks each criterion honestly ; (b) underlines errors such as “she want” → “she wants” ; (c) checks the presence of at least four connectors (first, moreover, however, therefore, in conclusion) ; (d) writes a kind, precise comment, for example : “Good ideas and rich vocabulary, but add a conclusion and check the verb agreements.”

6.5 Integration Activities, Evaluation and Remediation

Now let us combine everything from this lesson in one complete situation : buying and selling, polite requests, partitive articles, quantifiers, personal finances and professions.

EXERCICE 15 Integration : A day at the market with a budget

Situation : You are an apprentice tailor. Your master gives you 10000 FCFA and sends you to the market to buy supplies. Write a short dialogue (8–10 lines) with the seller, then a short paragraph (5 lines) explaining how you managed the money.

1. In the dialogue, use at least : two polite requests (Could you...? / Let me...), three partitive articles (a bunch of, a cup of, a piece of...) and two quantifiers (a few, some, much, many...).
2. In the paragraph, say what you bought, how much you spent, and how much you saved. Use first, moreover, therefore.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 2 (integration)

Possible dialogue :

— Good morning, madam. Could you show me a piece of white cloth, please?

- Of course. This one costs 3000 FCFA a metre.
- It is expensive. Let me see a few other pieces, please.
- Here you are. This one is 2000 FCFA.
- Fine. I also need a bunch of bananas and a cup of rice for lunch. How much is everything?
- 6500 FCFA, my dear.
- Thank you very much, madam.

Possible paragraph : First, I bought two metres of cloth for 4000 FCFA. Moreover, I bought food for 2500 FCFA. I spent 6500 FCFA in total ; therefore, I saved 3500 FCFA for my master. I did not spend much money because I compared the prices.

EXERCICE 16 Evaluation : final composition

Write a composition of 120–150 words : “Why I want to become a ...” (choose : mechanic, nurse, electrician, farmer, teacher, tailor, computer technician). Follow the five-step method (brainstorm, plan, draft, revise, final copy). Your teacher will mark it with the grid : content /5, organisation /5, grammar /5, vocabulary /5.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 3 (evaluation)

Marking guide : Content (clear profession, real reasons, personal project). Organisation (introduction, 2–3 body paragraphs, conclusion ; at least four linking words). Grammar (correct –s agreements ; correct quantifiers : much with uncountables, many with countables, a few = some, few = almost none). Vocabulary (at least five lesson words : apprentice, salary, customer, training, workshop, budget, profit, skill). Remove one point per category for repeated errors.

MÉTHODE Remediation : if your mark is low

1. Grammar problem ? Rewrite five sentences about professions with correct –s agreements (A nurse helps...).
2. Vocabulary problem ? Make a personal word list of 15 trade words with French glosses and learn five per day.
3. Organisation problem ? Copy the model composition and label each paragraph : introduction, body 1, body 2, conclusion.
4. Then rewrite the same composition and ask a classmate for a new peer correction. Compare your two marks.

À RETENIR**What to remember**

- A composition = introduction (present the job) + body (reasons, qualities, training) + conclusion (personal project).
- Use linking words : first, moreover, furthermore, however, therefore, in conclusion.
- Show the lesson : quantifiers (many, a few, much, each, both of), partitive articles (a bunch of, a cup of) and trade vocabulary.
- Never forget the -s at the third person singular : A carpenter works.
- Method : brainstorm → plan → draft → revise → final copy.
- Peer correction with a checklist improves both the writer and the reader.

7 ACTIVITÉ D'INTÉGRATION

8 ECONOMIC LIFE AND OCCUPATIONS

8.1 Objectifs de l'activité

- **Mobiliser** l'ensemble des savoirs de la leçon Economic Life and Occupations dans une situation unique et authentique : le marché Mokolo à Yaoundé.
- **Produire** un dialogue oral d'achat/vente intégrant les **polite requests** (requêtes polies) et les **partitive articles** (articles partitifs).
- **Analyser** un budget familial réel en utilisant les **determiners and quantifiers** (déterminants et quantificateurs) et réagir avec **So do I / Neither do I**.
- **Comprendre** un texte sur l'orientation professionnelle (apprentissage d'un métier) et en extraire le vocabulaire clé.
- **Rédiger** une composition personnelle argumentée : The trade I would like to learn and why.

8.2 Situation

À RETENIR Contexte : Une journée au Marché Mokolo

Imaginez que vous êtes un groupe d'élèves de Première Technique en stage d'observation à Yaoundé. Votre tuteur vous donne trois missions pour la journée. Vous disposez d'un dossier contenant trois documents authentiques.

Document 1 : Liste de courses et budget (10 000 FCFA) Vous devez acheter les articles suivants pour le déjeuner de l'équipe. Les prix sont ceux affichés chez Maman Simone, une vendeuse bien connue au marché Mokolo. Le total exact est de 10 000 FCFA après négociation sur les tomates.

Article	Description / Unités (Partitives)	Prix unitaire (FCFA)	Qté
Riz	a bag of 5 kg	2 500	1
Tomates	a heap of (tas)	500	3
Poisson (bar)	a piece of	1 200	2
Huile	a bottle of 1 L	1 000	1
Oignons	a net of (filet) 2 kg	800	1
Piment	a bunch of (botte)	200	2
Pain	a loaf of	300	2
Boisson (jus)	a carton of 6 bouteilles	1 000	1

Total après négociation (3 tas de tomates à 1 300 FCFA) : 10 000 FCFA exactement.

Document 2 : Relevé des dépenses mensuelles de la famille Ngonu (Yaoundé, 4 personnes)

Poste de dépense	Montant (FCFA)	% du total
Loyer	150 000	30%
Alimentation	200 000	40%
Transport	50 000	10%
Éducation (frais scolaires)	60 000	12%
Santé	20 000	4%
Épargne	20 000	4%
Total	500 000	100%

Rent (Loyer)	30 %
Food (Alimentation)	40 %
Transport	10 %
Education	12 %
Health (Santé)	4 %
Savings (Épargne)	4 %

Figure 1 – Répartition du budget mensuel de la famille Ngonu (Total : 500 000 FCFA). Source : Document 2.

Document 3 : Témoignage — « From Apprentice to Electrician »

EXEMPLE Texte de compréhension

My name is Paul. I am 19 years old and I live in Douala. Two years ago, I failed my Probatoire. I was very sad. My uncle, who is a master electrician, told me : “Let me teach you the trade. It is better than staying at home.” So, I became his apprentice.

At first, it was difficult. I had to wake up at 5 :30 a.m. every day. I carried heavy tools and crawled under houses to fix wires. Few of my friends understood my choice ; most of them wanted office jobs. But I liked the work. Each day, I learned something new : how to read a plan, how to test a circuit, how to respect safety rules.

Today, I earn a small salary, but I save a little money every month. I want to pass my CAP (Certificat d’Aptitude Professionnelle) next year. Both my uncle and my father are proud of me. None of us regret this decision.

Key vocabulary (Glossaire) : **apprentice** (apprenti), **master electrician** (électricien qualifié/maître d’apprentissage), **crawl** (ramper), **wires** (fils électriques), **circuit** (circuit), **safety rules** (règles de sécurité), **CAP** (Certificat d’Aptitude Professionnelle), **earn** (gagner), **save** (épargner).

LESAVAIS-TU ? L'apprentissage et le CAP au Cameroun

Au Cameroun, la formation professionnelle est pilotée par le MINEFOP (Ministère de l'Emploi et de la Formation Professionnelle). Le **CAP** (Certificat d'Aptitude Professionnelle) s'obtient après 2 à 3 ans d'apprentissage chez un **maître artisan** (maître d'apprentissage) validé, complété par des cours théoriques dans un **CFA** (Centre de Formation d'Apprentis) ou un **Lycée Technique**. L'examen est organisé par l'**OBC** (Office du Baccalauréat du Cameroun). C'est une voie d'excellence pour l'insertion professionnelle rapide, très valorisée dans les secteurs du BTP, de l'industrie, des services et du numérique.

8.3 Consignes

Travaillez en groupes de 4 élèves. Chaque groupe rend un rapport écrit et joue une saynète.

- Tâche 1 — Role-play (Speaking / Grammar / Vocabulary)** : Rédigez et jouez un dialogue de 2 minutes entre l'acheteur (vous) et Maman Simone (vendeuse). Utilisez **au moins** :
 - 2 requêtes polies différentes (Let me..., Could you...?, Can you...?).
 - 4 articles partitifs différents (a bag of, a heap of, a piece of, a bottle of, a net of, a bunch of, a loaf of, a carton of).
 - Une négociation de prix pour un article (ex: "Could you make it 400 FCFA for the heap?").
- Tâche 2 — Analyse budgétaire (Grammar / Speaking)** : À partir du Document 2, écrivez 5 phrases d'analyse en utilisant **chaque type de quantifieur** vu en cours (Part 1, 2, 3). Exemple : Most of the money goes to food. Ensuite, en groupe, réagissez à chaque phrase avec **So do I** ou **Neither do we** selon votre avis personnel.
- Tâche 3 — Compréhension de texte (Reading / Vocabulary)** : Répondez par écrit aux questions suivantes sur le Document 3 :
 - Why did Paul become an apprentice? (2 reasons)
 - Find in the text : one example of few, most, each, a little, both, none. Explain the meaning in context.
 - What are Paul's future plans?
 - Give the English definitions for : apprentice, crawl, wires, safety rules.
- Tâche 4 — Production écrite individuelle (Writing)** : Rédigez une composition de 150–180 mots : "The trade I would like to learn and why". Structurez votre texte :
 - Introduction : Présentez le métier choisi (électricien, menuisier, plombier, informaticien, coiffeur, etc.).
 - Corps : Expliquez why (intérêt personnel, demande sur le marché, revenu, fierté). Utilisez determiners/quantifiers (each step, many opportunities, a little patience, both theory and practice).
 - Conclusion : Projet concret (CAP, stage, création d'entreprise).

8.4 Ressources à mobiliser

DÉFINITION Polite Requests – Requêtes polies

- Let me + bare infinitive : Let me help you with that bag. (Proposition d'aide / offre de service).
- Could you + bare infinitive ? : Could you give me a better price ? (Politesse standard, demande courtoise).
- Can you + bare infinitive ? : Can you weigh the tomatoes ? (Moins formel, familier, demande de service simple).

ATTENTION Règle d'or

Après Let me, Could you, Can you, le verbe est toujours à l'infinitif sans to (bare infinitive). Never say : "Let me to help" or "Could you to give?"

DÉFINITION Partitive Articles – Articles partitifs (Quantités / Conteneurs)

Structure : a/an + noun of quantity + of + noun. Utilisés pour dénombrer des noms indénombrables (uncountable) ou des ensembles.

Contenant / Measure	Exemple (Document 1)
a bag of	a bag of rice
a heap of	a heap of tomatoes
a piece of	a piece of fish
a bottle of	a bottle of oil
a net of	a net of onions
a bunch of	a bunch of pepper
a loaf of	a loaf of bread
a carton of	a carton of juice

ATTENTION Accord au pluriel

Le nom de quantité (container) prend la marque du pluriel, pas le contenu : three heaps of tomatoes, two pieces of fish, two loaves of bread.

PROPRIÉTÉ Determiners and Quantifiers – Résumé des 3 parties (Programme MINESEC)

- Part 1 – Quantité générale (Affirmation / Négation / Question) : **some** (affirmatif, dén. pl. & indén.), **any** (négatif / interrogatif), **much** (indénombrable, surtout ? / -), **all (of)** (totalité), **most (of)** (majorité).
- Part 2 – Quantité faible (Nuance positive / négative) : **few / a few** (dénombrables pluriel) : few = presque aucun (négatif) ; a few = quelques-uns (positif).
little / a little (indénombrables singulier) : little = presque rien (négatif) ; a little = un peu (positif).
- Part 3 – Distribution, Dualité, Négation totale : **each** (chacun, focus individuel), **every** (tous, focus collectif), **many** (dénombrables, ? / +), **how many** (question), **both (of)** (les deux), **no** (aucun, + nom), **none (of)** (aucun d'entre eux, pronom).

DÉFINITION So / Neither – Accord / Désaccord (Short Answers)

- So + auxiliaire + sujet : Accord avec une phrase affirmative. "I like this job." – "So do I."
- Neither + auxiliaire + sujet : Accord avec une phrase négative. "I don't like office work." – "Neither do I."
- L'auxiliaire doit correspondre au temps et au verbe de la phrase originale (do/does/did/will/can/be/have).

EXEMPLE Exemples variés

- | | |
|--------------------|----------------------------------|
| "I am tired." | → "So am I." (auxiliaire be) |
| "I have finished." | → "So have I." (auxiliaire have) |
| "I can drive." | → "So can I." (modal can) |
| "I didn't go." | → "Neither did I." (passé did) |

8.5 Démarche et corrigé commenté

Corrigé guidé de l'activité d'intégration

Étape 1 – Rédaction et jeu du dialogue (Tâche 1)

EXEMPLE Dialogue modèle : At Maman Simone's Stall

Buyer : Good morning, Maman Simone. Let me see your tomatoes. They look fresh. Seller :

Good morning, my son. Yes, very fresh today. A heap is 500 FCFA. Buyer : Could you give me three heaps? Can you make it 1 300 FCFA for the three? Seller : Hmm, okay, 1 300 FCFA for three heaps. Anything else? Buyer : Yes. I need a bag of rice (5kg), two pieces of fish, a bottle of oil, a net of onions, two bunches of pepper, two loaves of bread and a carton of juice. Seller : That makes exactly 10 000 FCFA with the discount on tomatoes. Let me pack everything for you. Buyer : Thank you very much. Here is the money. Seller : Thank you. Good bye!

ATTENTION Points de vigilance pour l'évaluation

- Vérifier l'usage de bare infinitive après Let me / Could you / Can you (pas de to).
- Vérifier l'accord du partitif : a heap (singulier) vs three heaps (pluriel). Two pieces of fish (pas fishes).
- Prononciation de Could you /kədʊ/ et Let me /lemmi/.
- Intonation montante pour les questions (Could you...?), descendante pour les offres (Let me...).

Étape 2 – Analyse du budget familial (Tâche 2) Exemples de phrases produites par les élèves (une par type de quantifieur, couvrant les 3 parties) :

1. **Most of the money** goes to food and rent (70%). → Réaction : **So do we.** (C'est notre cas aussi).
2. **Some of the income** is saved, but **not much**. → Réaction : **Neither do we.** (Nous n'épargnons pas beaucoup non plus).
3. **Few families** can save 10% in Yaoundé today. → Réaction : **So do I.** (Je pense la même chose).
4. **A little money** is left for leisure after expenses. → Réaction : **So do we.**
5. **Each family member** contributes to the chores. → Réaction : **So do we.**
6. **Both parents** work to pay the fees. → Réaction : **So do we.**
7. **None of the children** pay rent. → Réaction : **Neither do ours.**

MÉTHODE Comment choisir le quantifieur ?

1. Identifier le nom : dénombrable (pluriel : friends, families) ou indénombrable (singulier : money, time) ?
2. Identifier le sens visé : quantité grande (many, much, most, all), petite positive (a few, a little), petite négative (few, little), nulle (no, none), distribution (each, every), dualité (both).

3. Vérifier la structure syntaxique :

- Quantifier + of + déterminant + nom : most of the money, both of the parents, none of the children.
- Quantifier + nom (sans of) : much money, many friends, each day, every student, no money.

Étape 3 – Compréhension du texte (Tâche 3)

1. **Why apprentice ?** (1) He failed Probatoire. (2) His uncle proposed to teach him the trade (Let me teach you).
2. **Quantifieurs dans le texte :**
 - Few of my friends understood... = Peu de mes amis (presque aucun, connotation négative / déception).
 - Most of them wanted office jobs. = La plupart d'entre eux (la majorité, > 50%).
 - Each day, I learned... = Chaque jour (individuellement, jour après jour, insistance sur la régularité).
 - I save a little money... = Un peu d'argent (petite quantité, connotation positive : il y en a, ça compte).
 - Both my uncle and my father... = Les deux (mon oncle ET mon père, dualité).
 - None of us regret... = Aucun de nous (négation totale du groupe, pronom).
3. **Future plans :** Pass CAP next year, become a certified electrician, eventually own a workshop.
4. **Définitions :** Apprentice = someone learning a trade from a skilled employer. Crawl = move on hands and knees. Wires = metal threads conducting electricity. Safety rules = regulations to prevent accidents.

Étape 4 – Composition type (Tâche 4)

EXEMPLE

Modèle de composition : The trade I would like to learn and why

The Trade I Would Like to Learn and Why

I would like to become a computer maintenance technician. In our modern world, every office, school and shop uses computers. Many young people in Cameroon have a phone or a laptop, but few know how to repair them when they break down. This is a real opportunity.

Each day, technology changes. I like solving problems. When a screen goes black or a virus attacks a system, I want to be the one who finds the solution. It requires a little patience and both theoretical knowledge (software, operating systems) and practical skills (changing a motherboard, cleaning a fan).

Most of my friends want to work in an office, but I prefer a technical trade. None of them

can fix a hardware issue. After my Baccalauréat Technique, I plan to do a BTS in Computer Maintenance or a specialized CAP. I want to open my own small workshop in my neighbourhood. It is a trade that gives dignity, a steady income, and the chance to help all members of my community stay connected.

À RETENIR Grille d'évaluation de la composition (sur 20)

- Contenu / Idées (pertinence, arguments, exemples) : 5 pts
- Organisation (paragraphe, connecteurs logiques : however, furthermore, therefore) : 4 pts
- Grammaire (Quantifieurs variés, temps verbaux, structures polies) : 5 pts
- Vocabulaire (métier, outils, verbes d'action, adjectifs qualitatifs) : 3 pts
- Orthographe / Ponctuation / Lisibilité : 3 pts

8.6 Bilan de l'activité

À RETENIR Ce que l'activité a permis de mettre en évidence

- Transfert des acquis : Les élèves ont dû passer de l'exercice de grammaire isolé (remplir des trous) à l'usage fonctionnel : acheter, analyser, argumenter, écrire.
- Contextualisation camerounaise : L'utilisation du FCFA, du marché Mokolo, du système éducatif (Probatoire, CAP, BTS, MINEFOP) et des noms locaux (Maman Simone, famille Ngono, Douala/Yaoundé) ancre l'anglais dans la réalité vécue, augmentant la motivation.
- Intégration des 4 compétences : Speaking (dialogue), Listening (écoute des autres groupes), Reading (texte Paul), Writing (analyse + composition).
- Difficultés récurrentes observées (pour remédiation) :
 - Confusion few / a few et little / a little (connotation négative vs positive).
 - Oubli du of après all / most / both / none quand il y a un déterminant (most of the money vs most people).
 - Mauvaise formation du bare infinitive après Let me / Could you (ajout de to).
 - Difficulté à choisir l'auxiliaire pour So / Neither (ex : So am I au lieu de So do I avec verbe d'action simple).
 - Pluriel des partitifs : two loaves (irrégulier), two pieces (pas fishes).

- Pistes de remédiation immédiate :

- Fiche exercices ciblée : Quantifiers Mini-Test (10 phrases à trous mélangés Part 1, 2, 3).
- Atelier oral : Market Price Negotiation (cartes prix + cartes budget, rotation rapide par paires).
- Réécriture guidée de la composition pour les notes < 10/20, avec cadre de phrases (skeleton essay : I would like to be a... Because... Each day... Both... Finally...).

Cette activité de synthèse valide la compétence « Communiquer dans des situations de la vie économique » et prépare efficacement les épreuves du Probatoire (Expression orale, Compréhension, Expression écrite).

9 MÉTHODES ET EXERCICES RÉSOLUS

10 ECONOMIC LIFE AND OCCUPATIONS

10.1 Buying and Selling at the Market (Speaking & Vocabulary)

MÉTHODE Réaliser un dialogue d'achat/vente au marché avec politesse et articles partitifs

Objectif : Échanger des informations pour acheter ou vendre des articles/denrées alimentaires en utilisant des formules de politesse et des quantificateurs partitifs.

1. Identifier les interlocuteurs et le contexte : Vendeur vs Acheteur, marché vs boutique. Adapter le registre (formel/poli).
2. Utiliser les formules de requêtes polies (Polite Requests) :
 - **Let me + bare infinitive** (Proposition d'aide : Let me help you with that bag.)
 - **Could you / Can you + bare infinitive + please ?** (Demande : Could you give me a kilo of rice, please?)
 - **Would you like + noun / to + infinitive ?** (Offre : Would you like some tomatoes?)
3. Employer les articles partitifs (Partitive Articles) pour exprimer des quantités indéfinies :

Structure	Exemple	Traduction
a bunch of + nom pluriel	a bunch of bananas	une grappe/régime de bananes
a cup of + nom non comptable	a cup of tea	une tasse de thé
a loaf of + pain	a loaf of bread	une miche de pain
a kilo of / packet of + nom	a kilo of sugar / a packet of biscuits	un kilo de sucre / un paquet de biscuits
a piece of / slice of	a piece of meat / a slice of cake	un morceau de viande / une tranche de gâteau

4. Structurer le dialogue : Salutation → Demande/Offre (quantité + article) → Négociation prix (optionnel) → Paiement → Remerciements/Au revoir.
5. Vérifier : Accord nombre (a bunch of bananas), politesse (please, could), vocabulaire spécifique (marché : stall, price, change, receipt).

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 8 Dialogue au marché : Complétion et réécriture

Énoncé : Complétez le dialogue ci-dessous entre un vendeur (V) et un acheteur (A) au marché Mfoundi. Utilisez les mots entre parenthèses sous la forme correcte (articles partitifs, forme polie). Traduisez les phrases en français.

1. V : Good morning, Madam. _____ (help / you)?
2. A : Good morning. Yes, _____ (like / buy) _____ (a bunch / banana) and _____ (a kilo / tomato).
3. V : Here you are. _____ (anything / else)?
4. A : _____ (let / me / see) ... Oh, _____ (could / you / give / me) _____ (a packet / sugar), please?
5. V : Certainly. That will be 3,500 FCFA.
6. A : Here is 5,000 FCFA. _____ (thank / you).
7. V : Here is your change. Have a nice day!

SOLUTION

Solution détaillée :

1. V : Good morning, Madam. **Can I help you? / Could I help you?**
Raisonnement : Offre de service standard. "Can I" ou "Could I" + bare infinitive. "Let me help you" est possible mais plus direct (souvent après avoir vu un besoin).
Français : Bonjour Madame. Puis-je vous aider?
2. A : Good morning. Yes, **I would like to buy a bunch of bananas and a kilo of tomatoes.**
Raisonnement : "Would like to" pour exprimer un désir poli. "A bunch of" + pluriel (bananas). "A kilo of" + pluriel (tomatoes). Attention : tomato → tomatoes (pluriel après kilo of).
Français : Bonjour. Oui, je voudrais acheter une grappe de bananes et un kilo de tomates.
3. V : Here you are. **Would you like anything else? / Is there anything else?**
Raisonnement : Proposition polie pour continuer l'achat. "Anything else" est l'expression consacrée.
Français : Voici. Désirez-vous autre chose?
4. A : **Let me see** ... Oh, **could you give me a packet of sugar**, please?
Raisonnement : "Let me see" (réflexion, bare infinitive sans "to"). Demande polie : "Could you give me" + objet. Article partitif : "a packet of" + nom non comptable (sugar).
Français : Laissez-moi voir... Oh, pourriez-vous me donner un paquet de sucre, s'il vous plaît?
5. V : Certainly. That will be 3,500 FCFA. (Phrase fournie).

6. A : Here is 5,000 FCFA. **Thank you / Thanks.**

Raisonnement : Remerciement standard.

Français : Voici 5000 FCFA. Merci.

7. V : Here is your change. Have a nice day! (Phrase fournie).

Conclusion : Le dialogue respecte les conventions de politesse (could, would like, please) et utilise correctement les articles partitifs (a bunch of, a kilo of, a packet of) pour quantifier des denrées non comptables ou en vrac.

10.2 Polite Requests and Partitive Articles (Grammar)

MÉTHODE Utiliser "So do I / Neither did he" et les adjectifs comme noms

Objectif : Exprimer l'accord ou le désaccord avec une affirmation (positive ou négative) et utiliser des adjectifs comme noms pour désigner des groupes de personnes.

1. Structure "So + Auxiliaire + Sujet" (Accord positif) :

- Reprend l'auxiliaire de la phrase originale (do/does/did/is/are/was/were/have/has/can/will/must).
- Ex : I like finance. → **So do I.** (Moi aussi).
- Ex : She saved money. → **So did she.**

2. Structure "Neither / Nor + Auxiliaire + Sujet" (Accord négatif) :

- Phrase originale négative (not, never, no...). Auxiliaire affirmatif dans la réponse.
- Ex : I don't like debt. → **Neither do I.** (Moi non plus).
- Ex : He didn't spend much. → **Neither did he.**

3. Adjectifs comme noms (The + Adjectif = Groupe de personnes) :

- Toujours précédés de **the**. Verbe au pluriel.
- **The rich** (les riches), **the poor** (les pauvres), **the unemployed** (les chômeurs), **the young** (les jeunes), **the elderly** (les personnes âgées).
- Ex : **The rich** should help **the poor**.

4. Piège : Ne pas confondre "Neither" (accord négatif) et "Either" (ajout négatif en fin de phrase : I don't like it either). Au Bac, "Neither/Nor" déclenche l'inversion sujet-auxiliaire.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 9 Finances personnelles : Accord et groupes sociaux

Énoncé : Lisez les phrases sur la gestion financière. Réécrivez-les en utilisant la structure indiquée entre parenthèses. Mettez le verbe à la forme correcte.

1. "I track my expenses every week." → My brother _____. (So)
2. "She doesn't have a credit card." → Her husband _____. (Neither)
3. "They saved 50,000 FCFA last year." → We _____. (So)
4. "He cannot invest in stocks now." → I _____. (Neither)
5. Complete : _____ (rich) often invest in real estate, while _____ (poor) struggle to save.
6. "The government helps _____ (unemployed) with training programs."

SOLUTION

Solution détaillée :

1. My brother **so does he**.
Analyse : Phrase affirmative, présent simple (track = do track). Auxiliaire do. Sujet he.
Inversion : So does he. (La structure canonique "So + aux + sujet" est attendue).
2. Her husband **neither does he**.
Analyse : Phrase négative (doesn't have). Accord négatif → Neither + auxiliaire affirmatif does + sujet he. Neither does he.
3. We **so did we**.
Analyse : Passé simple (saved = did save). Auxiliaire did. Sujet we. So did we.
4. I **neither can I**.
Analyse : Modale cannot (négatif). Accord négatif → Neither + modale can + sujet I. Neither can I.
5. **The rich** often invest in real estate, while **the poor** struggle to save.
Analyse : Adjectifs utilisés comme noms → The + adjectif. Verbe au pluriel (invest, struggle).
6. The government helps **the unemployed** with training programs.
Analyse : Unemployed (chômeurs) → the unemployed. Groupe de personnes.

Conclusion : Maîtriser l'auxiliaire (temps, mode) est la clé pour "So/Neither". Pour les adjectifs-noms, ne jamais oublier the et le verbe au pluriel.

10.3 Managing Personal Finances (Listening & Grammar)

DÉFINITION

Vocabulaire clé : Gestion des finances personnelles

- **Income** (revenus) / **Expenses** (dépenses) / **Budget** (budget)
- **Savings** (épargne) / **Investment** (investissement) / **Loan** (prêt/emprunt)
- **Interest rate** (taux d'intérêt) / **Collateral** (garantie/hypothèque)
- **Track expenses** (suivre ses dépenses) / **Make ends meet** (joindre les deux bouts)
- **Financial literacy** (éducation financière) / **Emergency fund** (fonds d'urgence)

10.4 Determiners and Quantifiers — Parts 1, 2 & 3 (Grammar)

MÉTHODE Maîtriser les déterminants et quantificateurs (Parties 1, 2 et 3)

Objectif : Choisir le bon quantificateur selon la nature du nom (comptable/non comptable), la polarité de la phrase (affirmative/négative/interrogative) et le sens (quantité grande/petite/nulle/totale).

1. Partie 1 : **some** / **any** / **much** / **all** / **most**

Quantificateur	Nom	Contexte
Some / Some of	Comptable pluriel / Non comptable	Affirmatif ; Offres/Demandes polies (interrogatives)
Any / Any of	Comptable pluriel / Non comptable	Négatif / Interrogatif standard / Conditions
Much / Much of	Non comptable seulement	Négatif / Interrogatif (quantité)
All / All of	Comptable pluriel / Non comptable	Totalité (100%)
Most / Most of	Comptable pluriel / Non comptable	Majorité (> 50%)

Règle "of" : Obligatoire devant déterminant (the, my, this) + nom : Some **of the** students. Interdit devant nom nu : Some students.

2. Partie 2 : **few** / **a few** / **little** / **a little**

Forme	Nom	Sens (Nuan
Few (peu, presque pas)	Comptable pluriel	Négatif : quantité insuffisante. Few people
A few (quelques-uns)	Comptable pluriel	Positif : existence d'une petite quantité. A few people
Little (peu, presque pas)	Non comptable	Négatif : We have little time (pr
A little (un peu)	Non comptable	Positif : We have a little time (nous avon

3. Partie 3 : **each** / **every** / **many** / **both** / **no** / **none**

- **Each** / **Every** : Singulier (distributif). Each = individu par individu (2+). Every = groupe (3+), ≈ All. Each student has a book. Every day I work.

- **Many / Many of** : Comptable pluriel. Affirmatif (formel), Négatif, Interrogatif. Many students. How many ?
- **Both / Both of** : Deux éléments, pluriel. Both options are good.
- **No + nom (nul, zéro)** : No student failed.
- **None / None of** : Pronom (remplace nom). Verbe singulier ou pluriel (souvent pluriel si "of" + pluriel). None of the students **have** arrived.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 10 Choix des quantificateurs : Texte à trous (Niveau Bac)

Énoncé : Complétez le texte suivant en choisissant le quantificateur approprié parmi la liste. Attention à la nature des noms (C = comptable, NC = non comptable) et au sens. Liste : **some / any / much / all / most / a few / few / little / a little / each / every / many / both / no / none of**.

Managing a small business requires discipline. (1) _____ entrepreneur must keep records. (2) _____ businesses fail because they have (3) _____ capital to start with. They borrow (4) _____ money from banks but (5) _____ banks require collateral. If you have (6) _____ savings, you can invest. (7) _____ my friends started businesses last year; (8) _____ them succeeded. (9) _____ the profit was reinvested. (10) _____ people think it's easy, but (11) _____ have the patience needed. You need (12) _____ luck too, but hard work matters (13) _____ day.

SOLUTION

Solution détaillée et justifications :

1. **Every** (ou **Each**). Justification : "Entrepreneur" singulier comptable, sens distributif (chacun). Every pour généralité (3+).
2. **Many**. Justification : "Businesses" pluriel comptable. Phrase affirmative (style formel/écrit) → Many. (A lot of possible à l'oral, mais Many attendu ici).
3. **little**. Justification : "Capital" NC. Sens négatif (insuffisant pour démarrer) → little (peu, presque pas). A little serait positif (ils ont un petit capital, ça irait).
4. **some**. Justification : "Money" NC. Phrase affirmative (action réelle : ils empruntent) → some.
5. **most** (ou **most of the**). Justification : "Banks" pluriel. Majorité. Devant nom nu → Most banks. (Si "the banks" → Most of the banks).
6. **some** (ou **a little**). Justification : "Savings" pluriel (souvent traité comme pluriel comptable en anglais : savings are). Conditionnel "If you have..." → some (quantité indéfinie positive). A little savings incorrect (savings pluriel).

7. **Both**. Justification : "friends" (impliqué 2 personnes car "Both" suit). "Both my friends" = mes deux amis. Verbe pluriel started.
8. **Both of** (ou **Both**). Justification : "Them" pronom → obligatoire of. Both of them. Verbe pluriel succeeded.
9. **All** (ou **All of the**). Justification : "Profit" NC. Totalité. All the profit ou All of the profit. Devant "the" → of recommandé.
10. **Many**. Justification : "People" pluriel. Phrase affirmative (concession) → Many.
11. **Few**. Justification : "People" (sous-entendu). Sens négatif (peu de gens ont la patience = critique) → Few. A few signifierait "quelques-uns ont la patience" (positif, contredit "but").
12. **a little**. Justification : "Luck" NC. Sens positif (il en faut un peu, c'est utile) → a little.
13. **Every**. Justification : "Day" singulier. Fréquence quotidienne → Every day (locution adverbiale). Each day possible mais Every plus naturel pour routine.

Conclusion : La distinction Few/A Few et Little/A Little (valence négative vs positive) et le choix Some/Affirmatif vs Any/Négatif-Interrogatif sont les pièges n°1 au Bac. Vérifiez toujours : Nom Comptable ? Non Comptable ? Phrase + / - / ? Sens "presque rien" vs "un peu" ?

10.5 Developing Interest in a Trade or Profession (Reading & Vocabulary)

MÉTHODE Lire et comprendre un texte sur un métier/une profession (Reading Comprehension)

Objectif : Extraire des informations explicites et implicites, identifier le vocabulaire technique du métier, et analyser la structure d'un texte descriptif/argumentatif sur une carrière.

1. Étape 1 : Anticipation (Before reading). Lire le titre, les sous-titres, les images. Prédire le thème (ex : A Day in the Life of a Welder, Why I Chose Nursing). Activer le vocabulaire connu (**tools, skills, training, apprenticeship, shift, salary, challenges, rewards**).
2. Étape 2 : Lecture globale (Skimming). Lire vite pour l'idée générale (Gist). Qui ? Quoi ? Où ? Ton (positif/négatif/neutre) ? Structure (Introduction → Formation → Quotidien → Avantages/Inconvénients → Conseil/Conclusion).
3. Étape 3 : Lecture détaillée (Scanning). Chercher des infos précises : dates, noms, chiffres, mots-clés de la question. Surligner les **connecteurs logiques** (however, therefore, moreover, because, although) pour suivre l'argumentation.
4. Étape 4 : Inférence lexicale (Guessing meaning). Deviner le sens des mots inconnus par le contexte (définition dans la phrase, opposition, exemple, famille de mots). Ex :

"The job is **grueling**, it requires long hours of standing and heavy lifting. → grueling = épuisant/dur.

5. Étape 5 : Réponse aux questions.

- Right/Wrong/Not mentioned : Se baser strictement sur le texte.
- Wh-questions : Réponse complète, en reprenant les mots du texte si possible (reformulation simple).
- Vocabulary : Synonymes/antonymes trouvés dans le texte.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 11

Compréhension de texte : "Devenir électricien industriel"

Énoncé : Lisez l'extrait et répondez aux questions.

Powering the Future : My Path as an Industrial Electrician

When I finished my Probatoire in Electrical Engineering at the Lycée Technique de Douala, I had a clear goal : become an industrial electrician. Many of my classmates chose office jobs, but **few** of them understood the satisfaction of seeing a complex machine start up because of your wiring.

My **apprenticeship** at SONARA lasted three years. It was **grueling** at times — night shifts, high voltage risks, and strict safety protocols. However, I earned **a little** money which helped my family, and I learned **a great deal** from senior technicians. **Most of** the theory I learned at school became real when I had to troubleshoot a faulty PLC (Programmable Logic Controller).

Today, I work for a manufacturing plant in Bassa. **Every** day brings a new challenge : preventive maintenance, reading blueprints, or programming automation systems. The salary is good, but **the real reward** is solving problems. **No** two days are alike. I advise young students : **do not** fear technical trades. They offer stability and pride. **Both** the country and your future need skilled hands.

Questions :

1. Are these statements Right (R), Wrong (W), or Not Mentioned (NM)? Justify with a quote.
 - (a) The writer studied at a technical high school.
 - (b) He earned a lot of money during his apprenticeship.
 - (c) He works in an office now.
2. Answer in your own words (based on the text) :
 - (a) Why did the writer choose this trade over an office job?
 - (b) What does "grueling" mean in paragraph 2? Find a clue in the text.
3. Vocabulary : Find in the text words/expressions meaning :

- (a) A period of training working for a skilled person (para 2).
 - (b) Documents showing technical plans (para 3).
 - (c) Maintenance done to prevent breakdowns (para 3).
4. Grammar in context : Explain the difference in meaning between "**few** of them understood" (para 1) and "I learned **a great deal**" (para 2). Why not "A few of them understood" ?

SOLUTION

Solution détaillée :

1. Right/Wrong/Not Mentioned :

- (a) R (Right). Justification : "When I finished my Probatoire in Electrical Engineering at the **Lycée Technique de Douala**..."
- (b) W (Wrong). Justification : Text says : "I earned **a little** money". A little = une petite quantité (pas "a lot"). Note : "Little money" (sans 'a') serait négatif (peu d'argent). Ici "a little" est positif mais quantité petite.
- (c) W (Wrong). Justification : "Today, I work for a **manufacturing plant in Bassa**." Pas un bureau.

2. Questions ouvertes :

- (a) He chose it for the satisfaction of seeing machines work thanks to his skills. (Citation : "the satisfaction of seeing a complex machine start up because of your wiring").
- (b) "Grueling" means extremely tiring and difficult. Clue : "night shifts, high voltage risks, and strict safety protocols".

3. Vocabulaire :

- (a) **Apprenticeship** (l'apprentissage / stage professionnel).
- (b) **Blueprints** (les plans / schémas techniques).
- (c) **Preventive maintenance** (la maintenance préventive).

4. Grammaire en contexte :

- "**Few of them understood**" (sans 'a') → Sens négatif : "Presque aucun d'entre eux n'a compris" / "Très peu ont compris". L'auteur insiste sur le manque de compréhension de ses camarades.
- "**A few of them understood**" (avec 'a') → Sens positif : "Quelques-uns ont compris (et c'est déjà bien)". Cela contredirait l'opposition "Many chose office jobs, BUT few understood...".
- "**A great deal**" → Quantificateur pour nom non comptable (theory, knowledge),

synonyme de a lot of / much, registre plus formel/écrit. Signifie "beaucoup / énormément".

Conclusion : La lecture active (surligner, annoter les quantificateurs, connecteurs) permet de valider Vrai/Faux et de deviner le vocabulaire technique (apprenticeship, blueprints, PLC) sans dictionnaire.

10.6 Writing about Trades and Professions (Writing & Integration)

MÉTHODE Rédiger une composition sur un métier/une profession (Writing)

Objectif : Produire un texte cohérent (150–200 mots) développant l'intérêt pour un métier technique, structuré en paragraphes, utilisant le vocabulaire spécifique, les quantificateurs et les connecteurs logiques.

1. Analyser le sujet : Identifier le métier visé (ou choisir le sien : welder, nurse, IT technician, accountant, mechanic). Identifier l'angle : Why I chose it / A typical day / Challenges and Rewards / Advice to youth.
2. Plan type (4 paragraphes) :
 - (a) Introduction (Hook + Thesis) : Accroche (citation, statistique, anecdote) → Présentation du métier → Phrase thèse : "I am interested in [Job] because it offers [Reason 1], [Reason 2], and [Reason 3]."
 - (b) Corps 1 : Formation et Compétences (Training & Skills). To become a..., one needs... (Vocab : **apprenticeship**, **vocational training**, **technical drawing**, **problem-solving**, **teamwork**). Utiliser must/have to (obligation).
 - (c) Corps 2 : Quotidien, Défis et Récompenses (Daily Life, Challenges, Rewards). A typical day involves... (Vocab : **shift work**, **deadlines**, **troubleshooting**, **hands-on**). Utiliser quantificateurs : Many tasks, Most of the time, A few challenges, Little free time. Contraste : Although it is hard, it is rewarding.
 - (d) Conclusion : Résumé + Ouverture/Conseil. In conclusion, [Job] is vital for the economy. I encourage young people to... (Utiliser Let us / Let me urge you to...).
3. Check-list linguistique (Self-Correction) :
 - Quantificateurs : Ai-je utilisé some/any/much/many/few/a few/little/a little/both/each/every correctement ?
 - Connecteurs : Firstly, Furthermore, However, Therefore, For instance, In conclusion.
 - Temps : Présent simple (faits généraux), Passé simple (expérience personnelle), Futur (projets).

- Registre : Semi-formel (pas de SMS, pas de contractions excessives en écrit formel do not vs don't).

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 12 Rédaction guidée : "Why I want to be a..."

Énoncé : Écrivez une composition de 150–180 mots sur le sujet suivant : "Developing an interest in a technical trade : The case of Industrial Maintenance." Utilisez au moins 5 quantificateurs différents étudiés (surlignez-les dans votre copie) et 3 connecteurs logiques.

SOLUTION

Proposition de rédaction corrigée (Modèle Bac) :

Building the Nation : My Interest in Industrial Maintenance

Every year, **many** young Cameroonians hesitate between university and technical schools. Personally, I have developed a strong interest in Industrial Maintenance because it combines practical skills, job security, and service to the industry.

Firstly, to enter this field, **each** student must master mechanics, hydraulics, and PLC programming. **Most of** the training happens in workshops, not just classrooms. **A few** months of internship in a plant like ALUCAM or SOCAPALM are compulsory. It is **not** an easy path; **little** free time remains during apprenticeship, but **a little** sacrifice builds a solid career.

However, the rewards are significant. **Both** preventive and corrective maintenance are vital. **No** production line runs without us. **Few** jobs offer such immediate visibility of results : a stopped machine restarts, the factory saves money. **Some** days are stressful with emergency breakdowns, **but** the team spirit solves everything.

In conclusion, Industrial Maintenance is the backbone of our economy. **Let me** advise my peers : choose a trade with **both** hands and brain. **Our** future needs skilled technicians.

Analyse des items requis (Vérification) :

- Quantificateurs (9 utilisés) : **Every** (l.1), **many** (l.1), **each** (l.5), **Most of** (l.6), **A few** (l.6), **little** (l.7), **a little** (l.7), **No** (l.10), **Few** (l.10), **Some** (l.11), **Both** (l.9, l.13). ≡
- Connecteurs (4 utilisés) : **Firstly**, **However**, **But** (coordination), **In conclusion**. ≡
- Structure : 4 paragraphes clairs (Intro, Formation, Réalités/Récompenses, Conclusion). ≡
- Vocabulaire technique : PLC programming, hydraulics, internship, preventive/corrective maintenance, production line, breakdowns. ≡

- Grammaire : Let me advise (politesse/requête), must master (obligation), combines (présent simple).

Conclusion : Ce modèle montre l'intégration naturelle des points de grammaire (quantificateurs, requêtes) dans une écriture argumentée sur un métier technique.

ATTENTION Les 5 erreurs qui coûtent des points au Bac (Unité 2)

1. Confusion **Few** vs **A Few** / **Little** vs **A Little** : Écrire "I have few money" (NC → little) ou "There are a few water" (NC). Surtout : ne pas saisir la nuance négative (few/little = "presque pas, insuffisant") vs positive (a few/a little = "quelques/une petite quantité, existe"). Astuce : Si la phrase exprime une plainte ou un manque → few/little. Si elle exprime une possibilité ou un espoir → a few/a little.
2. **Some** en phrase négative / **Any** en phrase affirmative (sauf offre/demande) : "I don't have some money" (Faux → any). "Do you want any coffee?" (Faux si offre polie → some). Règle : Some = Affirmatif + Offre/Demande polie. Any = Négatif + Interrogatif standard + Conditionnel.
3. Oubli de **of** après quantificateur + Déterminant (the, my, this, these) : "Most students" (OK) MAIS "Most of the students" (Obligatoire). "All the work" (OK courant) MAIS "All of the work" (Préférée formelle). "Both my friends" (OK) MAIS "Both of my friends" (Standard). None of, Some of, Many of : OF toujours obligatoire devant déterminant.
4. Accord verbe avec **None of** / **All of** / **Most of** + Pluriel : "None of the students has arrived" (Acceptable formel singulier) MAIS "None of the students have arrived" (Standard moderne, pluriel attraction). Au Bac : Pluriel recommandé après None of / Most of / All of + Nom Pluriel. Each / Every / No + Singulier → Verbe Singulier impératif.
5. Mauvaise formation des requêtes polies (Speaking/Writing) : "Let me to help you" (Faux → Bare infinitive sans to). "Could you to pass the salt?" (Faux → Bare infinitive). "Can you help me?" (Trop familier pour un examen formel → Préférer Could you / Would you mind + V-ing). Oubli de please en fin de phrase.

11 EXERCICES

11.1 Je vérifie mes connaissances

EXERCICE 17 QCM : At the market

Choose the correct answer (A, B or C).

1. I would like of bananas, please.
 - A. a loaf
 - B. a bunch
 - C. a tin
2. you show me that shirt, please?
 - A. Could
 - B. So
 - C. Much
3. money do you spend every week?
 - A. How many
 - B. How much
 - C. How few
4. "I like saving money." — "....."
 - A. Neither do I
 - B. So do I
 - C. So I do
5. There is rice left in the bag ; we must buy more.
 - A. a few
 - B. little
 - C. many

EXERCICE 18 True or False

Say True or False and justify your answer with a correct sentence.

1. We say "a loaf of milk".

2. "Could you help me, please?" is a polite request.
3. We use "how many" with uncountable nouns like money.
4. "Neither did he" expresses agreement with a negative sentence.
5. "A few" and "few" have exactly the same meaning.

EXERCICE 19 Definitions

Give a short definition in English (one sentence each) of the following words :

1. a customer
2. a bargain
3. a tontine
4. an apprentice
5. a budget

EXERCICE 20 Quick calculations

Mama Rose sells tomatoes at Mokolo market. Answer with a complete sentence.

1. One kilogram of tomatoes costs 500 FCFA. How much do 3 kilograms cost?
2. A customer buys a bunch of plantains at 1 500 FCFA and a tin of tomatoes at 800 FCFA. How much does he pay in total?
3. The customer gives a 5 000 FCFA note. How much change does Mama Rose give back?
4. Jean saves 2 000 FCFA every week in his tontine. How much does he save in 6 weeks?

11.2 Je m'entraîne

EXERCICE 21 Matching : foodstuffs and partitives

Match each foodstuff (1-10) with the correct partitive expression (a-j).

N°	Foodstuff	Letter	Partitive
1	bread	a	a bunch of
2	bananas	b	a tin of
3	rice (quantity)	c	a loaf of
4	sardines	d	a cup of
5	water	e	a bag of
6	eggs	f	a bottle of
7	groundnuts	g	a packet of
8	sugar (for tea)	h	a dozen
9	palm oil	i	a glass of
10	plantains	h	a heap of

Write your answers like this : 1 – c.

EXERCICE 22 Dialogue completion : At the shop

Complete this dialogue between a customer and a shopkeeper in Yaoundé. Use : could you, how much, a tin of, a loaf of, please, let me, a bunch of.

Shopkeeper : Good morning, madam. What can I do for you?

Customer : Good morning. (1) have (2) bread and (3) sardines, please.

Shopkeeper : Here you are. Anything else?

Customer : Yes. (4) are those bananas?

Shopkeeper : 500 FCFA the bunch.

Customer : (5) take two, (6) That is all, thank you.

EXERCICE 23 Grammar : determiners in context

Fill in the blanks with : some, any, much, few, a little, each, none of, both, every, many.

Mr Ndi is a trader at the central market in Douala. (1) morning, he opens his shop at 6 a.m. He sells (2) foodstuffs : rice, oil and beans. He does not have (3) free time during the day because he has (4) customers. (5) customer receives a receipt. (6) his sons help him after school. Unfortunately, (7) of his neighbours wants to learn the trade. He saves (8) money every month, but there are (9) banks near his house, so he keeps his savings in a tontine. He does not spend (10) money on useless things.

EXERCICE 24 Sentence transformation : So do I / Neither did he

Express agreement with each sentence using So + auxiliary + subject or Neither + auxiliary + subject.

Example : "Amina saves money every month." (Paul) → So does Paul.

1. "I buy my food at the market." (my brother)
2. "Clarisse did not spend her salary on clothes." (Eric)
3. "We are learning a trade at the technical college." (they)
4. "My father does not borrow money from the bank." (my uncle)
5. "The apprentices worked hard last week." (the students)
6. "I have never sold goods on credit." (she)

11.3 Je me prépare au Bac**EXERCICE 25** Reading comprehension : The apprentice dressmaker

Read the text carefully and answer the questions.

Text : Mariam is a nineteen-year-old girl from Bafoussam. After her BEPC, she decided to become a dressmaker because she has always loved beautiful clothes. Every morning, she walks to Madame Fotso's workshop in the town centre, where she is an apprentice with four other girls. She pays 5 000 FCFA every month for her training. At the workshop, she learns to take measurements, cut fabric and use a sewing machine. In the beginning, she made many mistakes, but now she can sew a complete dress in two days. After three years of training, Mariam wants to open her own shop near the market. She has already saved 150 000 FCFA in a tontine with her friends. "A trade is better than a diploma without a job," she often says. Her parents are very proud of her determination.

1. Say True or False and justify with a quotation from the text.
 - a. Mariam is an only apprentice in the workshop.
 - b. Her training is free of charge.
 - c. She can now sew a dress in two days.
2. Answer these questions in complete sentences.
 - a. Why did Mariam choose dressmaking?
 - b. What does she learn at the workshop? (Give two activities.)
 - c. How much has she saved for her future shop?
3. Find in the text the synonyms of : (a) errors ; (b) pleased.

4. What do these words refer to in the text : (a) “she” (line 3) ; (b) “her” (last line) ?

EXERCICE 26 Listening comprehension : The tontine meeting

Your teacher will read a dialogue twice about a tontine in a quarter of Bafoussam. Listen carefully and complete the grid, then answer the questions.

Member	Amount contributed	Frequency
Mr Kamga		
Mrs Abena		
Paul		

1. How many members are there in the tontine ?
2. Who receives the money this month ?
3. What will Mrs Abena do with the money ?
4. How much money is collected in total at each meeting ?
5. Write two polite requests you heard in the dialogue.

EXERCICE 27 Essay : My future profession

The Ministry of Employment and Vocational Training organises an essay competition in your school on the theme : “Choosing a trade for a better future.”

Write a composition of about 120 words in which you :

1. name the trade or profession you would like to embrace ;
2. explain two reasons for your interest in this trade ;
3. describe the training required and where you can receive it in Cameroon ;
4. say how this trade will help you and your community.

Use at least three quantifiers studied in the lesson (some, many, a few, much, each, both...) and one polite structure (let me... / could you...).

12 CORRIGÉS DES EXERCICES

CORRIGÉ Exercice 1 — QCM : At the market

1. B — a bunch. We say a bunch of bananas. A loaf is used with bread, and a tin with sardines or tomatoes.
2. A — Could. Could you show me that shirt, please? is a polite request. So and Much cannot introduce a request.
3. B — How much. Money is an uncountable noun, so we ask How much money...? How many is used with countable nouns.
4. B — So do I. To agree with a positive sentence in the present simple, we say So + do/does + subject. Neither do I would agree with a negative sentence.
5. B — little. Rice is uncountable. Little rice left means “almost no rice”, so they must buy more. A few and many are used with countable nouns.

Points de vigilance : distinguish how much / how many (uncountable vs countable) and So do I / Neither do I (positive vs negative agreement).

CORRIGÉ Exercice 2 — True or False

1. False. We say a loaf of bread and a bottle (or a packet) of milk. A loaf is a partitive for bread only.
2. True. Could you help me, please? is a polite request : could you + bare infinitive + please is the polite form studied in the lesson.
3. False. We use how much with uncountable nouns like money : How much money do you have? How many is for countable nouns.
4. True. Neither did he expresses agreement with a negative sentence in the past : “I did not go.” — “Neither did he.”
5. False. A few means “some, a small number” (positive idea), while few means “almost none” (negative idea) : I have a few friends (I am happy) / I have few friends (I am lonely).

Points de vigilance : the justification must be a complete, grammatically correct sentence, not just “True” or “False”.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 3 — Definitions

Suggested answers (any correct one-sentence definition is accepted) :

1. A customer is a person who buys goods or services from a shop or a trader.
2. A bargain is something bought at a price lower than its real value (a good deal).
3. A tontine is a group of people who contribute money regularly and give the total amount to one member in turn.
4. An apprentice is a person who learns a trade by working with a skilled worker or craftsman.
5. A budget is a plan that shows how much money you earn and how you will spend it.

Points de vigilance : a definition must contain a general word (a person who..., a plan that..., a group of people who...) and one complete sentence only.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 4 — Quick calculations

1. $3 \times 500 = 1\,500$. Three kilograms of tomatoes cost 1 500 FCFA.
2. $1\,500 + 800 = 2\,300$. He pays 2 300 FCFA in total.
3. $5\,000 - 2\,300 = 2\,700$. Mama Rose gives back 2 700 FCFA.
4. $2\,000 \times 6 = 12\,000$. Jean saves 12 000 FCFA in six weeks.

Points de vigilance : each answer must be a complete sentence with the unit (FCFA) ; show the operation before the result.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 5 — Matching : foodstuffs and partitives

Correct answers :

N°	Foodstuff	Answer
1	bread	1 – c : a loaf of bread
2	bananas	2 – a : a bunch of bananas
3	rice (quantity)	3 – e : a bag of rice
4	sardines	4 – b : a tin of sardines
5	water	5 – i : a glass of water
6	eggs	6 – h : a dozen eggs
7	groundnuts	7 – j : a heap of groundnuts
8	sugar (for tea)	8 – d : a cup of sugar
9	palm oil	9 – f : a bottle of palm oil
10	plantains	10 – g : a packet of plantains

Points de vigilance : a dozen is used for eggs (twelve); a heap of suits groundnuts sold in piles at the market ; a glass of water but a bottle of oil.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 6 — Dialogue completion : At the shop

Completed dialogue :

Shopkeeper : Good morning, madam. What can I do for you ?

Customer : Good morning. (1) Let me have a loaf of (2) bread and a tin of (3) sardines, please.

Shopkeeper : Here you are. Anything else ?

Customer : Yes. (4) How much are those bananas ?

Shopkeeper : 500 FCFA the bunch.

Customer : (5) Could you take two, (6) please. That is all, thank you.

Points de vigilance : let me is followed by the bare infinitive (let me have) ; how much asks for the price ; please at the end keeps the request polite. Note : a bunch of was a distractor — the bananas are already sold “the bunch” by the shopkeeper.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 7 — Grammar : determiners in context

Completed text :

Mr Ndi is a trader at the central market in Douala. (1) Every morning, he opens his shop at 6 a.m. He sells (2) some foodstuffs : rice, oil and beans. He does not have (3) any free time during the day because he has (4) many customers. (5) Each customer receives a receipt. (6) Both his sons help him after school. Unfortunately, (7) none of his neighbours want to learn the trade. He saves (8) a little money every month, but there are (9) few banks near his house, so he keeps his savings in a tontine. He does not spend (10) much money on

useless things.

Justifications :

- (1) Every + singular noun for a repeated habit ; (2) some in a positive sentence ; (3) any after a negative verb ; (4) many + countable plural (customers) ; (5) each + singular noun (customer) ; (6) both = the two sons ; (7) none of + plural noun = zero (verb agrees with plural neighbours → want) ; (8) a little + uncountable (money) = a small amount, positive idea ; (9) few + countable = almost no banks (negative idea, that is why he uses a tontine) ; (10) much + uncountable in a negative sentence.

Points de vigilance : check countable/uncountable before choosing (much/many, little/few) and the positive/negative meaning of a little vs little, a few vs few ; watch verb agreement after none of + plural noun.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 8 — Sentence transformation : So do I / Neither did he

1. "I buy my food at the market." (my brother) → So does my brother. (present simple, third person : auxiliary does)
2. "Clarisse did not spend her salary on clothes." (Eric) → Neither did Eric. (negative sentence, past : neither + did)
3. "We are learning a trade at the technical college." (they) → So are they. (auxiliary be in the present continuous)
4. "My father does not borrow money from the bank." (my uncle) → Neither does my uncle. (negative, present simple, third person)
5. "The apprentices worked hard last week." (the students) → So did the students. (positive sentence, past simple : auxiliary did)
6. "I have never sold goods on credit." (she) → Neither has she. (never makes the sentence negative ; auxiliary has)

Points de vigilance : the auxiliary in the short answer must copy the tense and auxiliary of the first sentence (do/does/did/be/have) ; use Neither whenever the first sentence is negative or contains never, not, no.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 9 — Reading comprehension : The apprentice dressmaker

1. True or False :
 - a. False. "She is an apprentice with four other girls" : there are five apprentices, so she is not alone.

b. False. "She pays 5 000 FCFA every month for her training" : the training is not free.

c. True. "Now she can sew a complete dress in two days."

2. Questions :

a. She chose dressmaking because she has always loved beautiful clothes.

b. At the workshop, she learns to take measurements and to cut fabric (she also learns to use a sewing machine).

c. She has already saved 150 000 FCFA in a tontine for her future shop.

3. Synonyms : (a) errors = mistakes ; (b) pleased = proud.

4. Reference words : (a) "she" (line 3) refers to Mariam ; (b) "her" (last line) refers to Mariam (her determination).

Barème indicatif (sur 10) : Q1 : 3 pts (1 pt par réponse justifiée par une citation) ; Q2 : 3 pts ; Q3 : 2 pts ; Q4 : 2 pts.

Points de vigilance : at the Probatoire/Baccalauréat technique, a True/False answer without a quotation earns no point ; answers must be complete sentences ; for reference words, name the precise person, not just "a girl".

CORRIGÉ Exercice 10 — Listening comprehension : The tontine meeting

Script lu par l'enseignant (à lire deux fois) :

Mr Kamga : Good evening, everybody. Welcome to our tontine meeting. Let me open the session, please. As usual, I contribute 10 000 FCFA every month.

Mrs Abena : Good evening. Could you write my name for 5 000 FCFA, please ? I contribute every month too. This month, it is my turn to receive the money. I will buy a sewing machine for my tailoring workshop.

Paul : And here is my contribution : 2 000 FCFA every week, so 8 000 FCFA for this month.

Mr Kamga : Thank you. Could you all sign the register, please ? See you next month.

Corrected grid :

Member	Amount contributed	Frequency
Mr Kamga	10 000 FCFA	every month
Mrs Abena	5 000 FCFA	every month
Paul	2 000 FCFA (8 000 FCFA this month)	every week

Answers :

1. There are three members in the tontine (Mr Kamga, Mrs Abena and Paul).
2. Mrs Abena receives the money this month ("it is my turn to receive the money").
3. She will buy a sewing machine for her tailoring workshop.

4. Total collected this month : $10\,000 + 5\,000 + 8\,000 = 23\,000$. 23 000 FCFA are collected at this meeting.
5. Two polite requests heard : “Could you write my name for 5 000 FCFA, please?” and “Could you all sign the register, please?” (also accepted : “Let me open the session, please.”)

Barème indicatif (sur 10) : grille : 3 pts (1 pt par ligne complète) ; Q1–Q3 : 3 pts ; Q4 : 2 pts (calcul exact exigé) ; Q5 : 2 pts.

Points de vigilance : for question 4, Paul contributes weekly, so his monthly amount is $2\,000 \times 4 = 8\,000$ FCFA — do not add 2 000 only ; polite requests must be quoted exactly with could you... please or let me....

CORRIGÉ Exercice 11 — Essay : My future profession

Model essay (about 120 words) :

Choosing a trade for a better future

Let me tell you about the trade I would like to embrace : carpentry. I have many reasons for this choice, but I will give two. First, I love working with wood and making beautiful furniture with my hands. Second, each family in my quarter needs tables, chairs and doors, so a carpenter always has customers.

To learn this trade, I can train for three years at a technical college or in a workshop in Douala, where a few experienced carpenters accept apprentices. The training is not expensive, and I will not need much money to start.

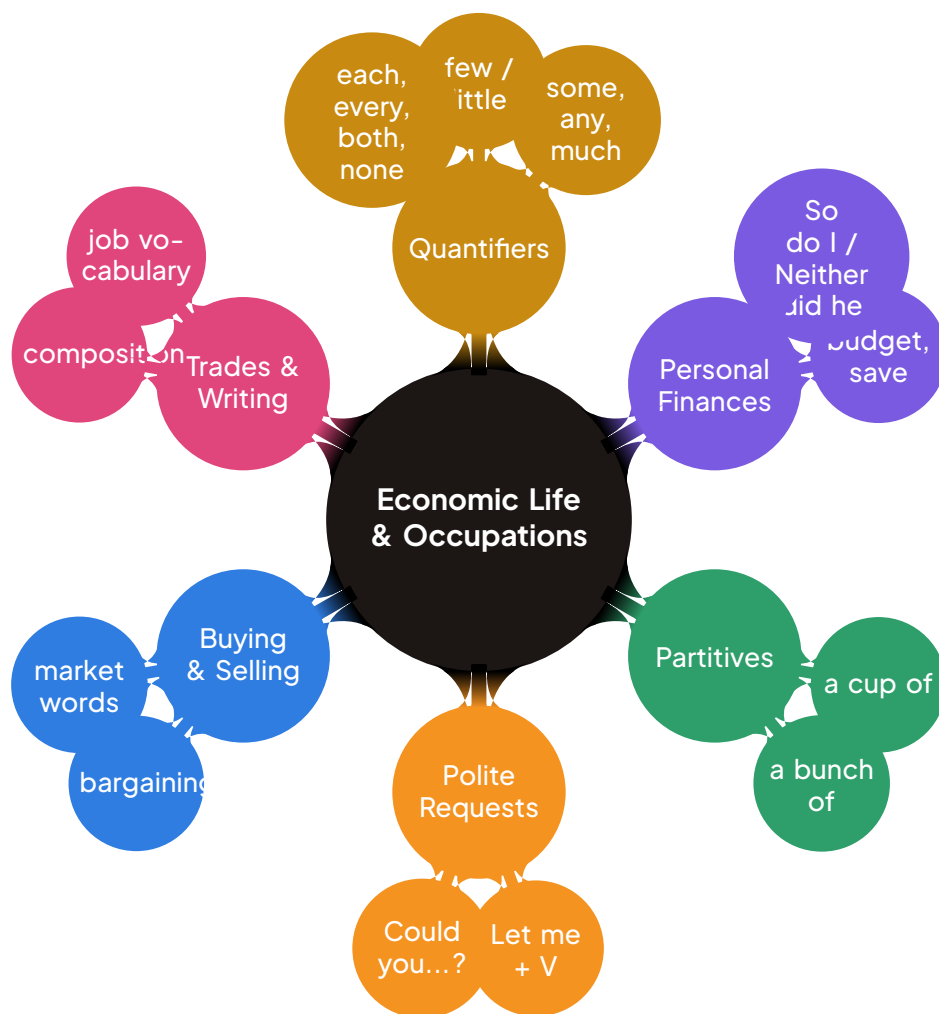
With this trade, I will earn a living, create jobs for some young people and build good furniture for my community. Could you imagine a better future?

Barème indicatif (sur 20) :

- Respect of the task (the 4 points treated) : 6 pts ;
- Coherence and organisation (introduction, development, conclusion) : 4 pts ;
- Vocabulary of trades and buying/selling : 4 pts ;
- Grammar accuracy (quantifiers, polite structure, tenses) : 4 pts ;
- Length (about 120 words) and presentation : 2 pts.

Points de vigilance : the three quantifiers and the polite structure must be used correctly (a wrong quantifier earns no grammar point) ; do not copy the model word for word ; stay within the theme and the word limit ; write in paragraphs, not in a list.

13 FICHE BILAN



Carte mentale de la leçon : les six blocs de savoirs à maîtriser (mind map of the lesson).

FICHE BILAN L'essentiel à connaître pour l'examen

1. Vocabulary — Buying and selling (au marché / à la boutique)

- **stall** (étal), **customer** (client), **seller/vendor** (vendeur), **price** (prix), **bargain** (marchander), **discount** (remise), **change** (la monnaie), **receipt** (reçu).
- Useful phrases : How much is it ? — It costs 500 FCFA. — Can you reduce the price ? — Here is your change.

2. Grammar — Polite requests and suggestions

Structure	Example	Use
Could you / Can you + V... ?	Could you give me a bag, please?	polite request
Let me + bare infinitive	Let me help you.	suggestion / offer
Please + imperative	Please weigh the tomatoes.	polite order

3. Partitive articles (pour les quantités) a **cup** of tea, a **bunch** of plantains, a **loaf** of bread, a **bottle** of oil, a **kilogram** of rice, a **piece** of soap, a **tin** of milk.

4. Managing personal finances (gérer son argent)

- **budget** (budget), **save money** (économiser), **spend** (dépenser), **earn** (gagner), **debt** (dette), **expenses** (dépenses), **income** (revenu).
- Agreement : I save money. → **So do I.** / He didn't spend much. → **Neither did he.**
- Adjectives as nouns : the rich (les riches), the poor (les pauvres), the unemployed (les chômeurs).

5. Determiners and quantifiers (à connaître par cœur)

Quantifier	Used with	Example
some / any	plural or uncountable	some rice / any money?
much / many	uncountable / plural	much water / many customers
few / a few	plural countable	few traders / a few traders
little / a little	uncountable	little time / a little money
each / every	singular	each student / every day
both (of) / none (of)	two / zero	both shops / none of them
all (of) / most (of)	plural or uncountable	all the food / most sellers

6. Trades and professions — Reading & Writing

- **trade** (métier), **carpenter** (menuisier), **tailor** (tailleur), **mechanic** (mécanicien), **hair-dresser** (coiffeur), **apprentice** (apprenti), **workshop** (atelier), **skill** (compétence).
- Writing method : introduction (the trade chosen) → body (reasons, skills, training) → conclusion (future plans).

À RETENIR

Checklist avant le Bac

- ☐ Je connais le vocabulaire du marché : price, bargain, discount, change, stall.
- ☐ Je sais formuler une demande polie avec Could you... ? et Can you... ?.
- ☐ J'utilise Let me + infinitif pour proposer de l'aide.

- ☐ Je maîtrise les partitifs : a bunch of, a cup of, a loaf of, a bottle of.
- ☐ Je sais répondre avec So do I et Neither did he.
- ☐ Je connais le vocabulaire des finances : budget, save, spend, earn, income, expenses.
- ☐ Je distingue much (indénombrable) et many (dénombrable).
- ☐ Je distingue few/a few et little/a little.
- ☐ J'emploie correctement each, every, both, none of.
- ☐ Je connais le vocabulaire des métiers : trade, apprentice, workshop, skill.
- ☐ Je sais rédiger une composition en trois parties sur un métier qui m'intéresse.
- ☐ Je relis ma copie : orthographe, accords, ponctuation.

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